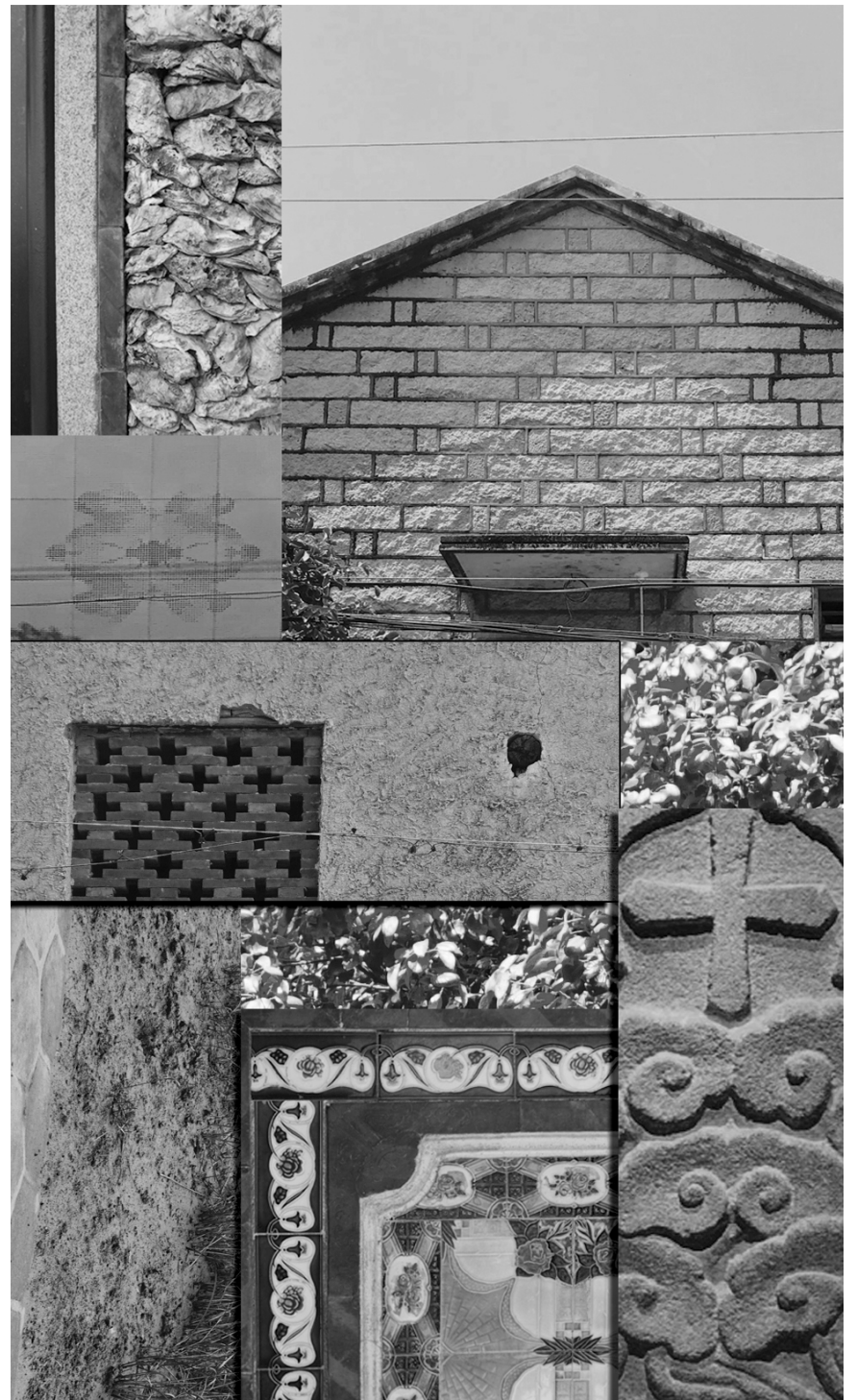


THE IMAGINARY CULTURAL LANDSCAPE OF THE CITY AND HARBOR IN QUANZHOU



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-Total number of words: 10,537

CHAPTER 1

THE CITY AND ITS HERITAGES



Figure 2: Zayton as imagined by a 15th-century European illustrator of The Travels of Marco Polo. Public source accessed from Wikipedia

1.1 Quanzhou, Chinchew, Zayton, Carp City

The word 'City', Saint Isidore of Seville¹ explanations in his etymologies, comprises two strands: one is 'urbs' meaning the stones or the material environment, while the other one is 'civitas',² signifying '*the city's role in the elaboration of social networks of meaning and denotes the emotions, rituals, value and belief systems which are formulated among these stones.*'³ This early medieval definition by the Archbishop of Seville of what constitutes the city holds true some one and a half millennia later for the city of Quanzhou in Minnan as an incarnation of this phenomenon on the other side of the world in China.

The Quanzhou of the twentyfirst century is a metropolitan region in the province Fujian (the capital city is Fuzhou) spread over more than 11,000 square kilometers of land and has a population of 8.65 million . Its territory and geographical terrain today growing beyond the original city as defined by its walled enclosure merging with the seaside towns and gaining its the name from the granite quarrying, processing and stone craftsmanship. It reaches all the way up to the hill counties in which the best oolong tea Tieguanyin (Iron Buddah) is still planted and from where the beautiful and precious Blanc de Chine white porcelain originates.

¹ Isidore of Seville (560-636), was an Archbishop of Seville for over three decades and a scholar. Widely regarded as 'the last scholar of the ancient world' by historian Charles Forbes René De Montalebert.

² The Latin word for 'city' was urbs, a resident was civis. 'Civitas seems to have replaced urbs as Rome (the ultimate urbs) lost its prestige'. Retrieved on July 15, 2020, from <https://www.etymonline.com/word/city>

³ Jein, Alternative modernity in French travel writing: engaging urban space in London and New York 1851-1986, (2016), Chapter One, p.23

Quanzhou is the principal city of the Minnan region and people speak Minnanness (or Hokkien as this language is often referred to South East Asian Chinese). This is a distinct Chinese language that Mandrain speakers cannot understand. The city ranked within the top 20 in the 2020 China GDP⁴ report, which is a souce of great pride for most of the citizens. Compared with the other Chinese cities or the mega-metropolitan areas in this ranking, Quanzhou is set up as a difference in the economic structure. Local private enterprises dominate most of the market, while in other cities national or state-owned bodies are the norm. Arguably this developes as a consequence of all its history in trade and the resulting overseas connections. Quanzhou has been a starting place for Chinese emigration to South East Asia and Taiwan⁵ following world-wide trade routes over time.

Situated at the southeast edge of China (Figure 1), Quanzhou, as a port city, was born and nurtured by the ocean. This has been its source of wealth and cultural exchange, but at the same time, consistently, the city and its surrounding areas have been subjected to the threats from nature and enemies arriving from the sea. When reading about the city, we notice that its name changes subtly in pronunciation and writing, referred to as Chinchew during the first half of the 20th century⁶ and Zayton between the 11th and 14th centuries⁷.



Figure 1: Location map of Quanzhou. Image source from Encyclopedia Britannica online access, edited by Author.

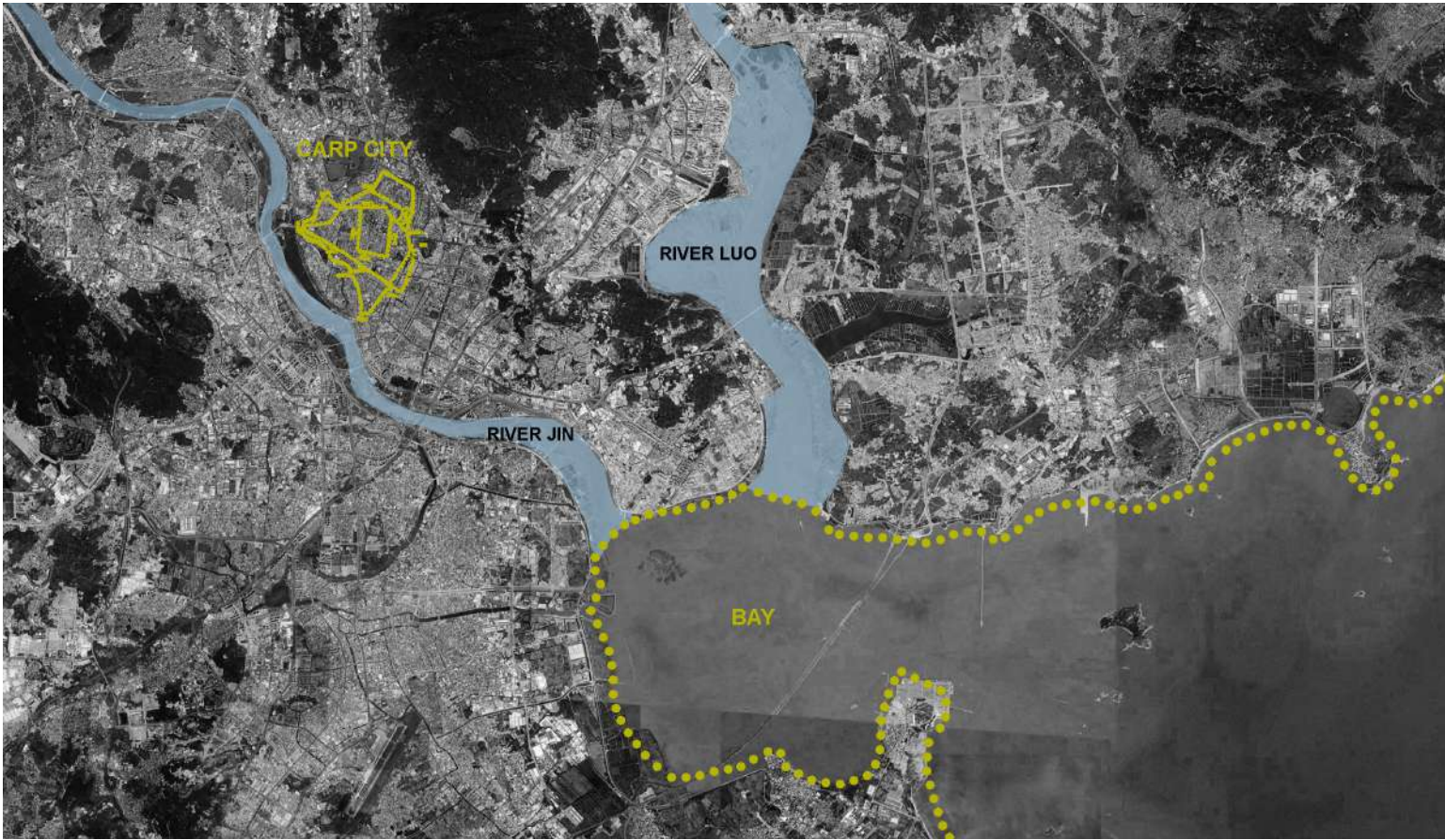


Figure 3: Quanzhou geographical map. Map source from Google Map, edited by Author

4 GDP: gross domestic product. It has been the most important standard for China government to measure a city, it has been considered a pride for the citizens if their cities have high GDP value.

5 There are about 9.5 million Overseas Chinese in more than 130 counties originated from Quanzhou, 0.76 million in Hongkong and Macau, about 9 million in Taiwan.

6 Chinchew is an English translation from the local language, the name could be found in westerns' writings at the first half of 20th century, as the missionaries and colonists came to this part of China following the open of Five Treaty ports between British government and Qing dynasty (1644-1912 AD).

7 Zayton, called by the Arabs, translated from the city's nickname: Citong, Tung tree city from local dialect.

As a Medieval gateway to the sea, opening up the emire to the world, Zayton developed into a phenomenal commerce node. It became known as 'the Mediterranean of the East' and the most famous tales of the city were described by the explorers by the Venetians Marco Polo (Figure 2) and Friar Odoric of Pordenone, as well as Moroccan Berber Ibn Battuta. They described the port as one of the best harbors they had ever seen, with ships and dockings of all sizes, vibrant markets in which merchants from distant lands exchanged their wares and treasures.⁸ Thus Quanzhou is strongly influenced by the different cultures and religions, especially by the Islam brought to Southern China by the traders from Arabia. The various belief systems and rituals have established themselves within unique urban practices.

People of Quanzhou are described as adventurous, flexible, multiracial, cosmopolitan, contradictory and hybrid. Their character is a result of the anthropological mixture⁹ resulting from the city as a trading hub and intersection of landbased and maritime trade routes throughout history.

The traditional central region of the metropolis is a peninsula leaning against Mount Qingyuan on one side and embraced by the river Luo at its east and the river Jin to its west (Figure 3). This was the location of historic walled city which was the region's civic and commercial centre, dating back to the Sui (581-618 AD) and Tang (618-907 AD) dynasties. Even in these ancient times, the fastest and most convenient transportation was the by boat and bridges spanned the rivers to allow for travel by land. The town was described as a carp fish, as Licheng or Carp City¹⁰, created by the imagination of the citicens who belived in Feng Shui, the Chinese geomancy.

If one stands at the peak of Mount Qingyuan, the outline of the city looks like the shape of a carp tail¹¹. The carp is an auspi-

cious symbol within Chinese culture; mainly a leaping carp '*often used to honor the capable princes and scholars as a symbol of upward mobility and competence*'¹². The most popular folklore describes that the city thrived because it was shaped like a carp's tail in geomancy, and that the emperors envied its prosperity. Because of this the emperors established a new prefecture that they called Yongchun.¹³ Located above and noth of Quanzhou it looked like a net trying to catch the carp and the idea was that this would prevent the city from flourishing. But this failed because the two pagodas of the Kaiyuan temple¹⁴ (Figure 4)penetrated the net, allowing the carp to swim freely into the river again.¹⁵

Fengshui, translates as 'wind-water' in English, is a physiognomy practice claims to use *energy forces to harmonize individuals with their surrounding environment, to bind the universe, earth, and humanity together*¹⁶. It is widely used to orient and plan buildings and urban towns. The story of carp tells us of the rise and fall of a city from the eyes of Quanzhouers. They used the symbol of the carp to explain real occurrences in a metaphysic manner. What becomes evident through this allegory is the Quanzhouers' strong belief in the interconnection between humans and nature, in which the existing harmonious balance should not be disrupted. This is the lore and mythology within which the city and its maritime business developed and blossomed.

But both inside and outside of China not much are known about this fascinating history and so following the failure of the first attempt in 2018, the government has been preparing the city's second submission to the Committee of UNESCO in a bid to have its complex cultural contribution to world history acknowledged as a World Heritage site. The submission is titled *Quanzhou: Emporium of the World in Song (960-1279 AD)-Yuan (1279-1386 AD) China*.

8 Municipality of Quanzhou, Quanzhou: a crucial port along the eastern maritime Silk roads, retrieved 30 July 2020, from <https://en.unesco.org/silkroad/content/quanzhou-crucial-port-along-eastern-maritime-silk-roads>

9 Su, Minnanese originally consists of the Han race from the central plain of China, the aborigines and the ethnic group from the islands, Min Shang (Minnanese Merchant), CCTV documentary (2010). Later on, as the flourishing of trade, large number of Arabs settled here and mixed with locals.

10 The translated word taken from Wang (2009)

11 The city and the East lake come together to form a picture of 'Carp playing with the pearl'. Wang, The local and the empire world (2009) p. 28

12 The carp leaping over the dragon's gate. A famous folklore in China, If a carp leaps over the Dragon's Gate it would become a dragon, and if it failed it would remain a fish. Ibid p.30

13 A mountain county at northwest of Carp city, now is under the administration of Municipality of Quanzhou

14 Kaiyuan Temple, a buddhist temple in the center of Carp City that dated back to 618 AD (Tang dynasty), the two towers: East and West pagodas have been the symbol of the city.

15 Wang, The local and the emire world (2009) p. 33

16 Wikipedia, Fengshui, retrieved on 15th July 2020 from https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Feng_shui



Figure 4 Photo of East and West pagodas in Kaiyuan Temple. (photo of 2008). open source from nopic.com, edited by Author

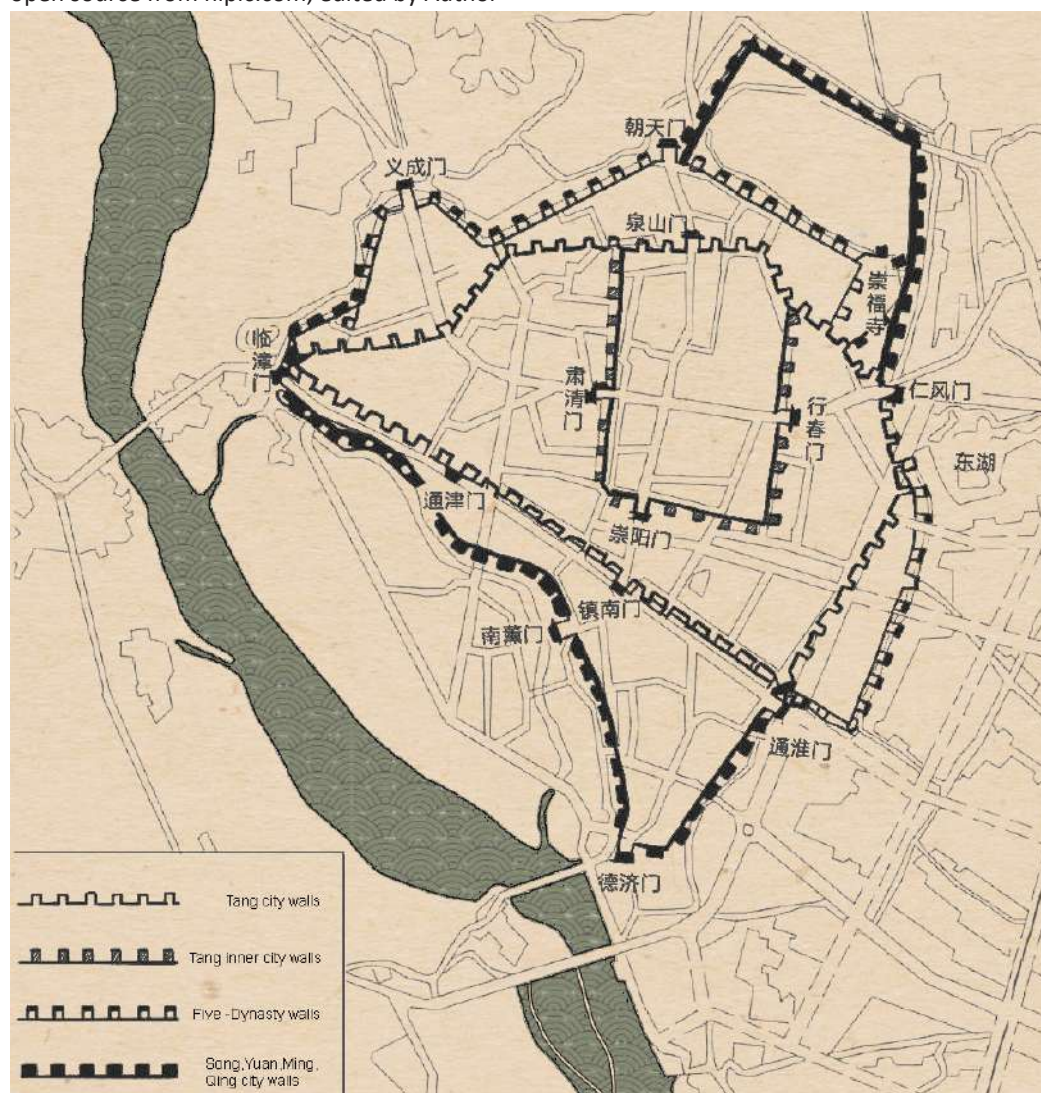


Figure 5: Historical City walls. Tang (618-907), Five-Dynasty (907-960), Song (960-1279), Yuan (1279-1368), Ming (1368-1644), Qing (1644-1912). The map shows the shape of the Carp tail. The image source from Yang (2015), edited by Author

1.2 UNESCO World Heritage Nomination

In 2018, the heritage body Historic Monuments and Sites of Ancient Quanzhou (Zayton) received the disappointing decision based on the recommendations made by ICOMOS and IUCN¹⁷ that the city should 'not be inscribed on the World Heritage List'.¹⁸ During the 42nd UNESCO World Heritage conference held at Manama, Bahrain, the decision was amended to allow the application 'to [be] referred back to the State Party for additional information [and] resubmitted to the following Committee session for examination'¹⁹

The nomination in 2018 consisted of sixteen separate components in Quanzhou, to represent '*the geocultural influence and intercultural exchanges between China, southeast Asian ports and further afield*'.²⁰ The selection consisted of sea-river-land infrastructures, such as a bridge, docks, pagodas, rock inscriptions that recorded the voyages, and archeological kiln that survived as an early industrial site and multiple places of worship exemplifying the diverse religious practices and beliefs. By means of these the State Party who was responsible for the submission wanted to make a statement of Quanzhou's glorious past.

The reason for the initial refusal according to the ICOMOS evaluation report was on account of the relatively weak justification of the selected components' Outstanding Universal Value (OUV), which is the determining criteria. Essentially the structure of the nomination dossier was unclear. While the components were lumped under one concept – Maritime Silk Routes – the comparative analysis focused on individual port cities such as Goa in India, Venice and its lagoon in Italy, etc. Later the State Party clarified that the nomination was not about a port city, but was a combination of individual sites that were meant to reflected the essence of the city as a node for the Maritime Silk Routes. ICOMOS remained unconvinced. The sixteen sites were too disparate to collectively reflect this concept partially owing to the challenging thematic framework that required trans-regional and trans-national cooperation, which was not well developed within the application. The arguments were not justified either as a group or as individual components. What let the application down additionally was that historical connections

among the sites were not understood very well. On top of this some components lacked visual integrity and were vulnerable to development pressures. There were also questions regarding the authenticity of the conservation works of the individual sites. There was not sufficient evidence that the extensive restoration and alteration were done according to the original.

At the same time, ICOMOS considered the sixteen sites had not met the high standard of evidence as outlined in section on Cultural Criteria (Figure 6). Although ICOMOS agreed the maritime histories of Eurasian trade and cultural exchange were unquestionably valuable to world history, they had reservations about the maturity of the theme and in particular the unresolved historical significance and fragmentation of the sixteen selected components. ICOMOS queried the weak concept of this serial approach from which to convincingly develop the collective narrative. The report further pointed out that no urban fabric was included as contextual setting for the isolated components, and that little of the port itself remained – a fundamental component of the theme based on the maritime trade routes.

The Uganda delegation, pointed out that there seemed to be a fundamental misunderstanding between the State Party and the advisory body.²¹ While ICOMOS was concerned about the framework's integrity, the State Party considered the Maritime Silk Routes as a context to support the value of the individual sites. The State Party reminded ICOMOS to refer to the common evaluation standard rather than setting the global thematic study of Maritime Silk Routes as the precondition for the project. Eventually, the committee amended the draft decision in the meeting on 29th June 2018 to allow for a revised application to be submitted.

17 ICOMOS: International council on monuments and sites; IUCN: The International union for conservation of nature. Refer to the report WHC/18/42, p.68-79

18 Refer to the decisions adopted during the 42nd session of the World Heritage Committee, WHC.18/42.COM/18, retrieved on July,27,2020 from <https://whc.unesco.org/en/sessions/42COM/decisions/>

19 Refer to the verbal discussion from several state members during the conference dated on 29th June 2018, Live record retrieved on July,27,2020 from <https://whc.unesco.org/en/sessions/42COM/records/?day=2018-06-29>, the discussion started at 2:16:00 till the end of the video; The evaluation terminology to be referred to the evaluation document <https://whc.unesco.org/archive/2010/whc10-34com-inf8B4e.pdf>

20 Refer to the report WHC/18/42, p. 68

21 Refer to the verbal discussion from several state members during the conference dated on 29th June 2018, Live record retrieved on July,27,2020 from <https://whc.unesco.org/en/sessions/42COM/records/?day=2018-06-29>, the discussion started at 2:16:00 till the end of the video

Cultural Criteria	State Party Arguments	ICOMOS Comments
Criterion (ii) Exhibit an important interchange of human values, over a span of time or within a cultural area of the world, on developments in architecture or technology, monumental arts, town-planning or landscape design.	Demonstrate the cultural exchanges in the maritime trading through: - Urban cultures, architectural design & art. - The writing of Marco Polo, Odoric da Pordenone and Ibn Battuta; -The remains of the docks, shipwrecks and porcelain; -Diverse religious beliefs & practices	The history of maritime trading is relevant to the criterion; - Not all components are relevant; - Components weakly demonstrate the argument; - The argument can be strengthened through further transnational thematic research.
Criterion (iii) Bear a unique or at least exceptional testimony to a cultural tradition or to a civilization which is living or which has disappeared	Demonstrate: - The prosperity and inter-cultural encounters based on the maritime routes and port city functions; - A fusion of cultures and religions. (in additional documents); - The significance of Min-nan Culture (a mixture of China' central Plain agricultural and the maritime civilisation, featured by its openness and inclusiveness), as Quanzhou is its birthplace and centre.	The criterion is potentially appropriate for a port city or a cultural route. - It is not demonstrated at this stage due to the inability to convey the proposed OUV; - Insufficient evidence presented about the 'fusion'; - Min-nan culture is not well integrated into the argument for OUV, little information is presented to sustain the justification; - The relation of Min-nan culture and the history of maritime trade need to be strengthened.
Criterion (vi) To be directly or tangibly associated with events or living traditions, with ideas, or with beliefs, with artistic and literary works of outstanding universal significance	Direct association with - Zheng He's (1371-1430s, Chinese mariner, diplomat, admiral in early Ming, has huge influence in South East Asian culture) voyages to the west and the spread of Islam, Manichaeism, Hinduism and Nestorianism; - Renowned literary works, The travels of Marco Polo, The travels of Friar Odoric, Rihla, etc. In additional document: - The stone craftsmanship in the components is the evidence of traditions; - Sea-river-inland connectivity underpinned the city's prosperity.	- Multicultural character of this period is potentially demonstrated through the association with various religions, but insufficient material to establish the value within its geo-cultural context; - The association with Zheng He voyages is not supported because no correlation between the period of nomination and the later Zheng He voyages; There are contested interpretations about the impacts of the voyages (military campaigns in South-east Asian and Sri Lanka); - Neither Zheng He or Marco Polo are directly relevant to the serial nomination; - Later arguments are both under-developed, not supported with evidence.

Figure 6: Summary of UNESCO nomination cultural criteria evaluation

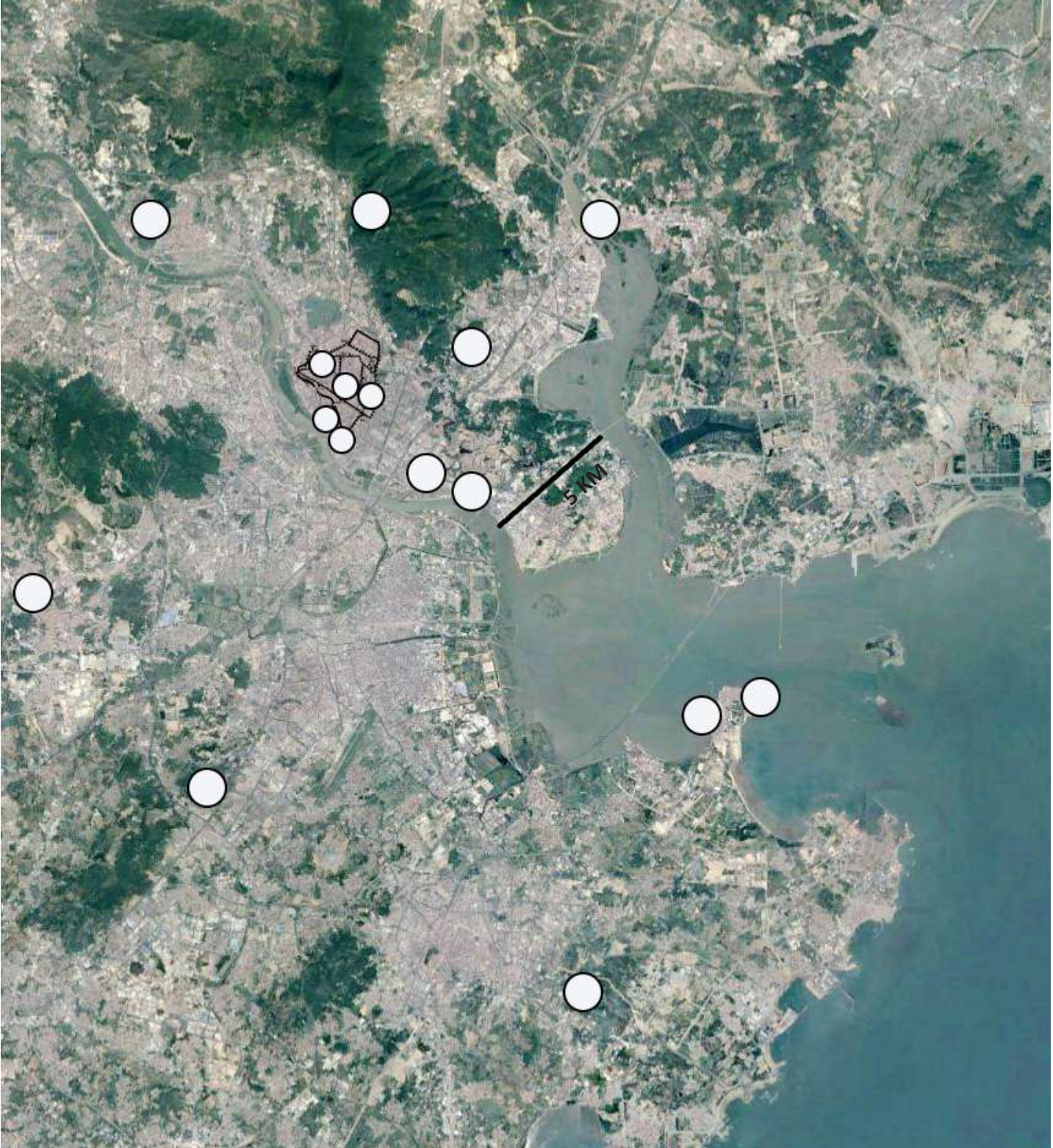


Figure 7: Map of UNESCO World Heritage bid in 2018

Nomination sites	Timelin Tang Dy Song Dy Yuan Dy Ming Dy Qing Dy
Historic Sites o vf Maritime Navigation and Trade	
Wanshou Pagoda	Built: 11 R&A: 19
Liusheng Pagoda	Built: 11 R&A: 13
Shihu Dock	Built: 71 R&A: 10 a bridge eral tim
Meishan & Wenxing Dock (Estuary Docks)	Built: So R&A: 20
Jiuri Mountain Wind-Praying Carvings	Earliest Modern CO miss
Zhenwu Temple	Built: 96 R&A: Qi
Tianhou Temple	Built: 11 R&A: Qi 1990s (l lanthrop
Jinjiaoyi Klin site	Built: 10 Abando Excavati
Multicultural Sites	
Confucius Temple	Built: 97 R&A: ea built
Stone Statue of Lao Tze	Built: So
Kaiyuan Temple	Built: 68 R&A: Re
Two Islamic tombs for the third and fourth Sa-habahs	Built: 7t R&A: Yu
Qingjing Mosque (Masjid a-Ashab)	Built: 10 R&A: 13 from Sh mad Qu
Satue of Mani in Cao'an Temple	Built: 11 R&A: 13
Related Historic Sites of Urban Infrastructure	
Site of Deji Gate	Built: 12 R&A: Yu Excavati
Luoyang Bridge	Built: 10 R&A: M

Period	Area / Buffer Area	Description	ICOMOS report Comments
11th century: 618-907 AD 12th century: 960-1279 AD 13th century: 1279-1368 AD 14th century: 1368-1644 AD 15th century: 1644-1912 AD			
1131-1162 1981	16.7ha / 86.03 ha	- Five-storey stone pagoda at the highest point of Quanzhou Bay; - SP considers it acted as a navigation marker; - A 'calabash' shaped top was added in late 20th century	- Minimal evidence of navigational aids provided; - Setting of Liusheng is affected by the surrounding modern container port & industrial buildings.
1111-1136 - 1369 - 1982	2.34ha / 29.29ha	-Five-storey stone pagoda overlooks Shihu dock; - SP considers it acted as a navigation marker; - Bounded on some sides by a modern container port;	
1163-741 1968 (an over-water fortress, paths and stairs) & several in Song	3.13ha / 11.23ha	- Located in the outer port facing the mouth of the main channel; - Original Song stone base remains	- They are of interest to the articulation of Quanzhou as a port; - Estuary docks have older foundations with newer upper parts which was restored in recent times and affected by modern development which disrupt their context; - Shihu has been impacted by the nearby construction of a modern harbour.
1196-1202	19.78ha / 56.82ha	- Located at the juncture of the river & sea; - Important for commerce and coastal defence of Fashi port (one of the most prosperous ancient ports); - Temples worshipping sea god is nearby; - A stone 'casket' shaped pagoda on Wenxing; - An archaeological shipbuilding site, stone anchors, some stone Islamic tombs in the area; - Shipwreck within the land area;	
1266-1266 1991 (by a UNESCO)	11.4ha / 45ha	-10 well-documented carvings, reflecting sailing traditions in each season of the year; -Carvings are records of winds and prayers & ceremonies for smooth sailing; -Ceremonies were organized to pray King Tongyuan(god of the sea);	
1267-990 1991 (wooden features)	3.84ha / 72.76ha	-For the worship&offer of sacrifices to Zhenwu Dadi (a Taoist deity & god of the sea) -Original stone features remain	Lack of authenticity due to the restoration
1296-1306 1991 (wooden feature)-copy overseas Chinese philosophers)	0.78ha / 4.31ha	-The oldest & highest-level existing temple for sea goddess Tianhou; -Original stone foundation remains -Main hall houses a Tianhou statue and a large-scale wall painting;	Lack of authenticity due to the restoration
14th century 1991: 14th century 2002-2003	6.45ha / 61.7ha	-Important production site of export porcelain (evidence of the prosperity of trade), an example of other such kilns (more than 150) - Products from the sites were found in south-east Asia, South Asia & East Africa archaeological excavations; And in shipwrecks in Xisha Islands & South China Sea; - Identified four dragon kilns, a workshop and other artefacts in 2002-2003	- Landscape context is somewhat overwhelmed by the shelter covering the site and other new constructions; - A new construction of highway near the buffer zone has an impact.
1276-984 1991 each dynasty since it was	3.59ha / 8.15ha	- The largest existing complex featuring architectural elements of Song,Yuan,Ming & Qing dynasties in South-east China; - Notable for its age and grand size.	- Elements from Song,Yuan,Ming,Qing
1296-1306	1.9ha / 4.25ha	- Located in a scenic reserve outside Quanzhou; - Represents the cultural diversity of the area.	- Interesting feature but has a relatively weak relationship with the maritime trading routes.
1306-1306 Recent time	7.23ha / 9.06ha	- One of the oldest structures in Quanzhou; -Notable for its incorporation of Asian&Western influences, including Buddhist & Hindu elements; - Layout has changed overtime; - Many components within the temple,such as a scripture repository.	- Significant within China although the associations with maritime trading routes is not well-established. - Lack of authenticity due to several times of restorations throughout history
14th century Tang 1962 - 1990	4.08ha / 17.58ha	- Chinese & Arabic architectural styles; - Zheng He visited these tombs in 1417 before his voyage to the west.	- Important within China context although not rare.
1309 Song 1310 (by a famous pilgrim Ibn al-Battuta, Ahmad Bin Muhammad) - 2002	2.15ha / 5.23ha	- One of China's earliest mosques; - Demonstrate the introduction of Islam to China via maritime trading routes; - Inscriptions demonstrate that the mosque was built by traders involved in maritime commerce.	- Setting of the mosque is affected by urban development pressures.
1131-1162 Song 1939 - Modern period	2.69ha / 6.91	- The world's only remaining stone statue of Mani (founder of Manichaeism or Zoroastrianism); - It was a statue originally. - Some Yuan features remain, others were rebuilt in modern period;	Lack of authenticity due to the restoration
1230 Song 1962-1991 2001-2002	0.39ha / 4.7ha	- An excavated archaeological site in downtown Quanzhou; - The only remaining gate among the seven gates; - Discovered the carvings of Hinduism, Nestorianism, Islam & Buddhism in Song & Yuan.	- Important local archaeological site although the links with maritime history are not strong.
1056-1059 1993 - 1996	14.69ha / 209.8ha	- First flat beam cross-sea stone bridge in China; - It made the land-sea transport possible; - It made Fuzhou(capital of the province) and other cities within the reach of Quanzhou port; - Includes a Cai Xiang (refectory chief facilitated the project) memorial, steles & statues.	Lack of authenticity due to the major restoration in 1993

1.3 Conclusion

Quanzhou has been consistently associated within the submission documents for the UNESCO bid but also in the mainstream media with the Maritime Silk Routes and the State Party has been eager to empower the role of this single locality as the node for the vast tangible and intangible interconnections of trade by sea. But the question that arises from the choice of the nominated components is, if they really have the cultural authority to represent this piece of history and further encourage visitors to imagine the story they have been assigned to tell? As a native Quanzhouer, I find the city's association with the Maritime Silk Routes intriguing, but as a phenomenological flâneuse, I myself struggle to experience this rich historical aura to unfold at those locations. As an academic researcher, I find the submission dossier too generalized, arbitrary in its conclusion and fragmentary.

My intertwined critical thinking about the failed UNESCO bid to harness the cultural complexity of Quanzhou as I have learned to understand it, has founded the basis for this essay. The State Party's approach to highlight the culture and heritage of Quanzhou was mostly result-driven, based on superficial clichés and not engaging with a rigorous process of researching the fabric of the city. The choice of the maritime infrastructure and diverse religious sites as evidences were “automatically” selected by the State Party to fill the blank page as the concept. The claims made by the topic of the Maritime Silk Routes was too ambitious to endow the isolated objects or sites with the weightiness of this history. There had not been enough research-based evidence to explain how these diverse and fragmented situations evidence the importance of Quanzhou in terms of its global impact on trade culture. This essay aims to explore an alternative approach to look at the urban grain and through this imagine the phenomena of Quanzhou's culture and history.

However, I do not intend to scrutinize the submission reports or to find out if the justifications were well-testified and to what degree had they been understood, nor do I attempt to improve on the application's documentation and communication. My research is therefore based on an alternative method. The listed-World-Heritage-sites approach is not the only way to gauge the richness of heritages. Still, such external gazes are useful as a self-reflective tool for the public, especially for the decision-makers, to allow them to reexamine preconceived understandings as historical narratives, right or wrong approaches to the preservation of sensitive urban environments – both tangible and intangible – and by means of this to contemplate how this can facilitate people's relationship to the historical meanings of these objects and places here and now. According to the report, the advisory body noted the exciting history of Quanzhou, but ‘*without the needed sites*’ that can tell this story meaningfully.²² And the justification for the city as a UNESCO World Heritage site was ultimately dependent on how the components could testify to this past by means of the chosen locations. It is evident that ICOMOS did not accept the connection made between the objects at their respective locations and the particular history told by the State Party about the Maritime Silk Routes.

This essay suggests engage with the concept of ‘urbs’ and there by the built objects in their locations, and that of ‘civitas’ as their enactment as a testimony to Quanzhou's history. The focus will be on how they collectively communicate to tell stories. The fundamental inspiration of this article is Quanzhou itself and how the complexity of its diverse inhabitants and visitors have been embedded in the urban environment. It was only a matter of how to discover and engage with this. The problem of narration had of course been the weakness of the of sixteen components chosen by the State Party for their bid and their failure to evoke empathy. The aim is not to verify the truth of the history, but rather, discern the historical and cultural meaning of certain phenomena embedded in very specific locations as a whole and as a part of city's memory and their interrelationship.

22 Refer to the report WHC/18/42, p. 79

23 Chen (2019), Abramson (2016) Wang (2009), Duncan (1902), Quanzhou culture and history online archives <http://www.mnwhstq.com/szzy/qzwszlqwk/>, Library of Congress <https://www.loc.gov/>, etc.

24 Norberg Schulz (1979), Dwyer & Alderman (2008), Lynch (1990), etc.

25 Hermeneutics particularly the interpretation of texts, which may be any material object or tangible expression imbued in some way with human meaning (a personal journal, a poem, a sculpture, a garden, and so forth); Lifeworld refers to the tacit context, tenor and pace of daily life to which normally people give no reflective attentions, includes both the routine and the unusual, the mundane and the surprising.

26 Zhuang, Brief discussion on the restoration and protection of the mangrove in Quanzhou Bay, (2008)

27 Luoyang Bridge or Loyang Bridge, was built in 1053 AD, managed by Cai Xiang, the chief of Quanzhou prefecture. Refer to the UNESCO site list chart.

28 Norberg Schulz, In Genius Loci: Towards a Phenomenology of Architecture (1979)

29 Memorial landscape through the metaphors of ‘text’, ‘arena’, and ‘performance’. Dwyer & Alderman, Memorial Landscapes: analytic questions and metaphors (2008)

The study of the UNESCO documents led me to become interested in the relationship of the city to its harbor on the river. What is the story of interdependence of this duo both in the past and still readable now by means of the built environment? Are there any direct or metaphoric expressions of their symbiotic existence? How should we look at them? And how do we, the citizens and visitors make sense of those places? How does human inhabitation provide the context for understanding the meaning of such locations? The research was carried out with those questions in my mind, inspired also by the abstraction of the city's essence readable in Italo Calvino's *Invisible Cities* to use the process of creating collages out of visual images to describe thus creatively my understanding of Quanzhou. I explored the links between objects by pondering which elements in the image should be connected visually and as memories and associations and why. With my growing understanding of the city, I then embarked on researching the descriptive and pictorial histories and cultural observations of Quanzhou, with an emphasis of the influence flowing from the ocean up the river through the harbor and from there into the city as archival research.²³

Meanwhile, my theoretical framework included subjects such as that of the Genius Loci and memory,²⁴ inspired by the Quanzhouers' cosmological understandings of the place. At the same time, I consistently also referred to the cultural aspect of geography. From this basis, I chose two significant areas for my site investigations, including first-hand on-site observations and interviews. Motivated by the description of Seamon, the field study focused on my views of hermeneutic-phenomenological research referred to as 'lifeworld'.²⁵ This is therefore not a data-based report, instead the interdisciplinary and creative research essay allows the readers to follow my narrative and experience with me how the theme unfolds. The argument will be a that of a total openness, the point is not to agree or disagree.

Any narrations of Quanzhou and its maritime trade routes is from the outset frustrated by the fact that the elementary linkage

between city and the sea by means of the connecting river are no longer present. The natural or humanmade topography and geography have changed over time, most obviously perhaps the water body of the mother river Jin which has shrunk significantly. It is no longer able to support the imagination of the thousands of junks that once sailed from it into Quanzhou's harbor. The landscape setting of the thousand-year-old Luoyang Bridge has also been changed when the government started planting mangroves in the river Luo in 1956²⁶ to reduce the huge waves that threatened riverside inhabitation. The disappeared wave was also the fundamental factor that caused the conveyance on the river to subside and eventually allowed the stone bridge to be built across the water²⁷.

In this respect I have been very much inspired by the idea of Christian Norberg Schulz on the missing symbolic and existential meanings within cultural landscape.²⁸ All places have the hermeneutic attribute, which allows the public to read and reinterpret their histories by means of the existing cultural displays that bring new meanings to such sites.²⁹ Instead of holding onto just one way of understanding the city through its clichéd urban mythology, the objective is to discover the other stands and narratives that are in existence and find out what they represent. My journey has therefore been to reexamine the relationship between the once lively trade area and the lifeblood of the city's commerce, the river docks.

Harbor

海

Nuture by
the ocean

Threats from nature

Heterotopia

Influence from afar

Everyayness

Earth

Water



Sea

Canal

市

City

The imagination of the city was created by means of photo collage before the research. The texts were introduced upon the end of the research to describe such an initial abstraction of Quanzhou's essence. The research started from the interconnections of the objects in the collage and developed further by studying two specific sites.

Clan

Commerce



Urbs

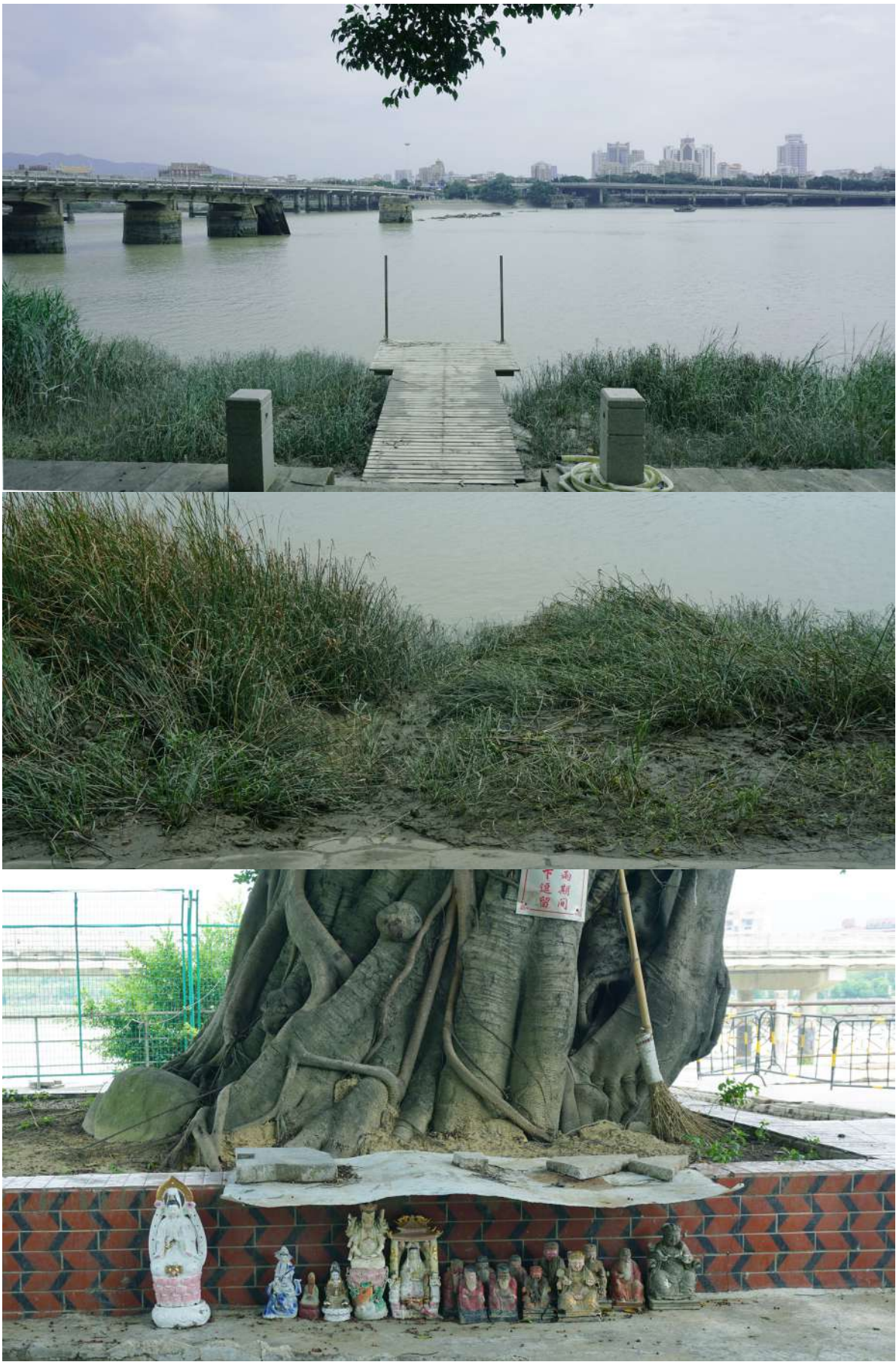
Civis

Genius Loci

Inhabitant

CHAPTER 2

THE CULTURAL LANDSCAPE OF JUBAO



Images show the view looking towards Jubao from the other side of river Jin. Also the tree and the Genius loci next to the river bank.

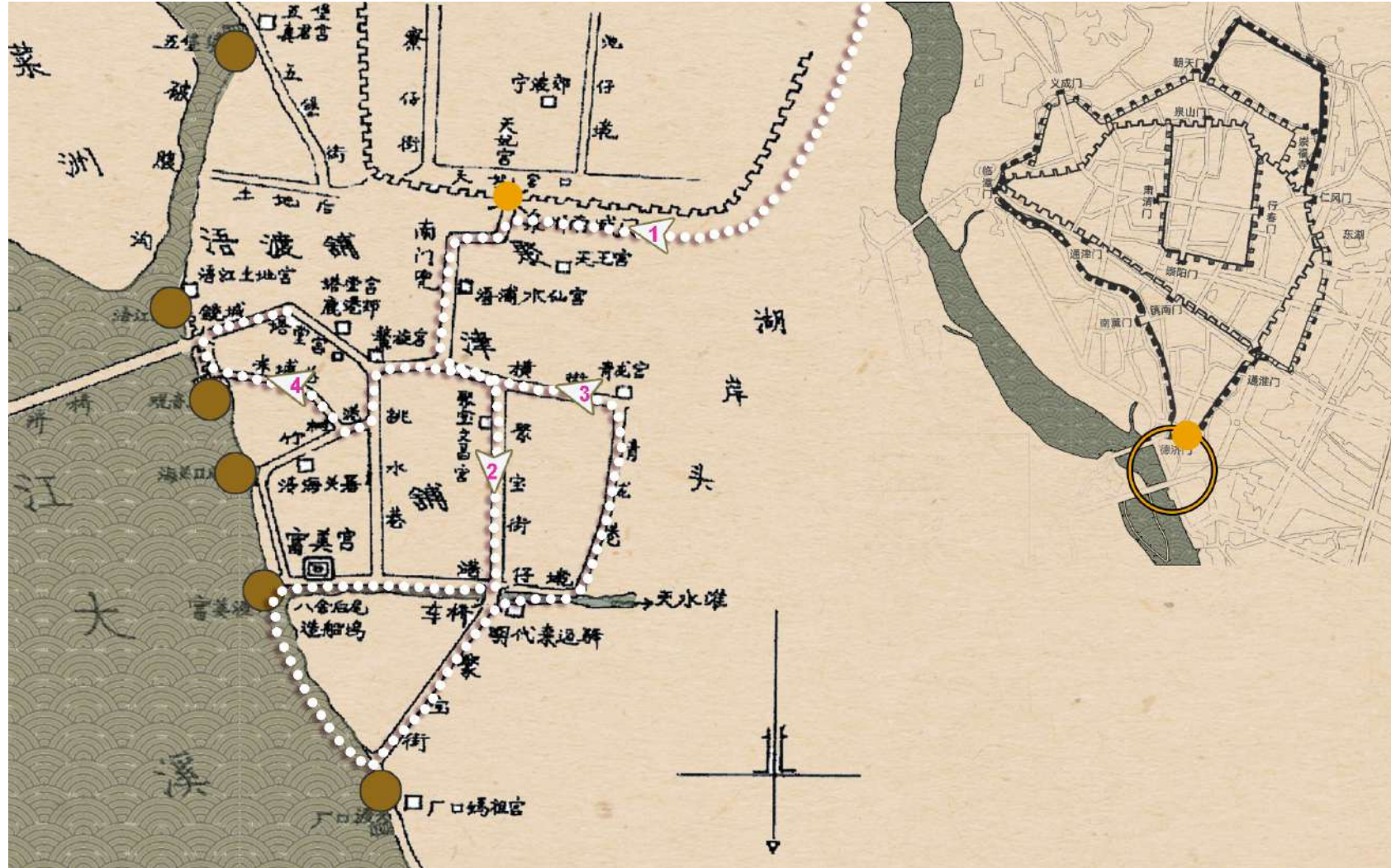


Figure 1: A partial map shows the temples and Dutou (dock) of Jubao in late Qing dynasty (1644-1912 AD) and its location in Carp City. Edited by author, source from Fumei Gong committee, Quanjun Fumei Gong Gazette (1997)

I am choosing the area of Jubao and its embankment docks as an example (Figure 1). Because Jubao was where the traders from 'ten thousand' nations landed, during the Song (960-1279 AD) and Yuan (1279-1368 AD) dynasties, following the rising tide, it was where the ancient custom-house, currency exchange stations were situated. Jubao means 'treasure accumulating,' originated from the name of the main street in this area. And just as its name implies, the street was the bazaar to gather and link goods and peoples together for exchange. Locals also call this area Chengnan, meaning 'South of the City,' as this area was historically located between the river Jin and the southmost city gate, Deji gate. Both in a geographic and social sense, Jubao had become both a 'city' in its own right and a 'harbor.' But it was also where the city and the harbor areas intersected. If I were to compare Jubao with Marco Polo's hometown: Venice, I would say it was like the Rialto bridge area where the trade and financial activities of that city happened, but in a sense, it was also like the Arsenale for some specific periods in history.

As stated by Wang¹, the meaning of Chengnan contains the *secret of history*². The south field outside the city gate had traditionally been a pure farming and fishing urbs, inhabited by the peasants. Followed the development of the international trading activities, Chengnan gradually yet powerfully influenced the walled city but still was not entirely adapted to its civis system. It was in such a delicate phenomenon, Jubao revealed an identity of being Michel Foucault's heterotopia³, as it was a real space that existed alongside Carp City's everyday spaces. Jubao bore the traits of a heterotopia because it reflected the dynamic cultural landscape of the port city it belonged to; It was not a freely-accessible place as people arrived and left with the purpose of commerce exchange; Also, both the attributes of the harbor and city had been juxtaposing with each other simultaneously in this place. Such a characteristic will be more explicit and intriguing following in my actual footsteps.

The French term *flânerie* means the act of strolling was best to describe my roam in Jubao that started from the ruin of Deji Gate and reached the river. Inspired by Walter Benjamin's essays through his strolling, the paper was composed of my reflective observation from the current urbs of the area. Jubao is a picturesque and idle township today. The layout largely remains as what it was: the main commercial streets, the mansions of rich and elites, the temples dedicated to different spirits, but the activities and participators have gone. There is no

actual historical map of the area available to my knowledge, yet from the descriptions, we can read that '*the layout of the streets and alleys was like a spider net*'⁴ where merchants arrived with their small laden boats by means of the canals. We can perceive the rich variety of the spaces here: mixed, spontaneous and diverse, yet all were very much dedicated to exchanging and communication. The essence of each crossing point of the street grids and intersections with the network of the canal were influenced by and supportive of the individual activities related to commerce.

Marco Polo described the harbor of Quanzhou as a sprawling waterfront teeming with camphorwood junks propelled by huge rattan sails.⁵ Today the debate about which of the township's current ports was the exact one mentioned by the famous Venetian traveler is still ongoing⁶ and highly likely will never be resolved. While the Jubao bund was descriptive of an image of Quanzhou's heydays, the impression of Marco Polo remained generalized and he did not speak about any particular harbor structures nor how the dock men might have worked. Yet today, all of the piers or docks have disappeared from this area. And we have no traces of the Middle-Age port structures. Hence, my investigation suggests to discover the meanings of Jubao's space through the here and now of its urban environment.

1 Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the 'Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology'* (2016), p.33

2 *Ibid*

3 Foucault, *Of other spaces, Heterotopias*, Translated from *Architecture, Mouvement, Continuité* no.5 (1984), p.46-49

4 Zhuang, quote from Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the 'Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology'* (2016)

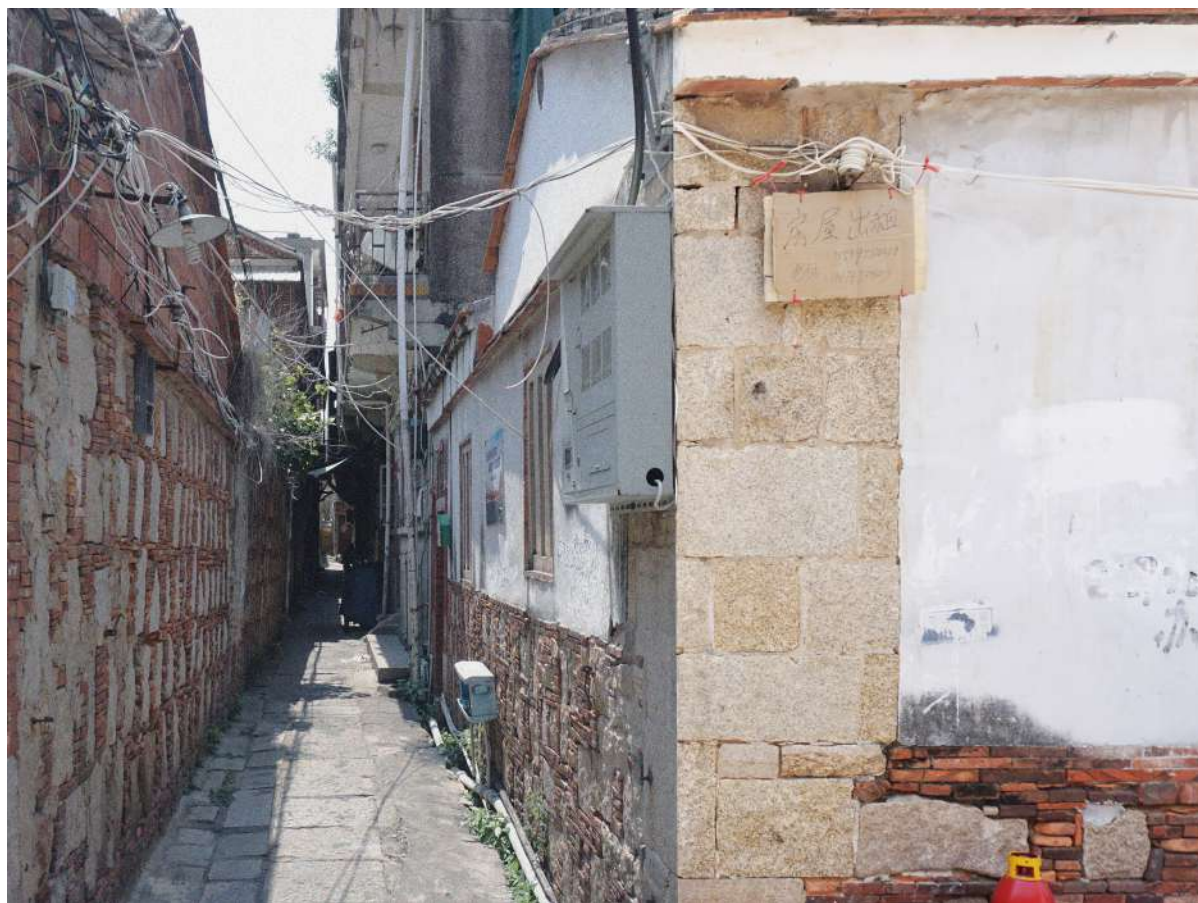
5 It was not the original words from Marco Polo. The summarized description was adopted from Bordewich, *A fabled City from China's Past* (1993)

6 Some said it was the Jubao port, some suggested Houzhu port which is further to the east at the estuary of river Luo.

A picturesque scene of the “entrance” of Jubao taken from the ruin of Deji Gate, which was an isolated component nominated as a potential UNESCO World Heritage Site. Such an essence of Quanzhou is what the State Party and government are promoting .



Typical scenes in Jubao showing the juxtaposition of deserted historical house and the still-in-use structures occupied with daily activities; And the intersections of streets and alleys remain enticing for a historical imagination.



2.1 Canals

An important feature that helped to identify Jubao with both city and harbor were the canals that ran through the township to access the river directly. In the past, the canal was like the lymphatic system of Jubao, assuring the circulation of trade, absorbing the necessary nutrition for the town, yet keep Jubao healthy and resilient.

While in the 1960s still, Wu described the treasures arriving upon the canals or the smell of the salted fish and clams⁷, today it is the stink of the open ditches that affront the visitors' nose. The trenches of the canal are lined with granite parapets on each side and some parts have an extra railing. The water runs quite a bit deeper than its flanking walkway and the embankments are visible. The water is turbid and still and announces the cessation of mobility. On a hot summer day, the motionless green trees and the green water provide us with a view of tranquility (Figure 2&3). This scene is ubiquitous in Carp City. The canals are called Bagua⁸ trenches and date back to the Tang dynasty, built originally as moats and open sewers. While the fortress of the walled city has been modified, extended and in the end destroyed, the water system remains. The picturesque scene belies the smell and the burning sunlight reflected from the dry pavement in the temperature of 40 degrees Celsius, and on my walk, I was able to find some respite next to the railings under the lush trees in an improvised corner set up for tea (Figure 4).

The shop owner of this little haven corners told me the canals used to be lifeblood of the neighborhood. Their water was essential to wash rice grain and clothing. For the children, they were a wonderland. On old photographs, we can see that the canals look much broader, and the water was clean. Maybe after the 1970s, they stopped functioning as they always had, they were forgotten and despised, the people started dumping waste into the water. The shop owner continued: 'It is like the mechanical components; if you don't activate and maintain them, they will not work for you. In fact, the government and community have been monitoring the canals regularly, including the maintenance of the hard surface of the road, railings and the water purifying system. The smell is much better now.' It is evident that the shop owner and his family are happy about the extra outside space in front of their property and enjoy the tranquility of this outdoor place to sit on warm summer nights. Along the canals, this family was not alone to ignore the smell of the canal. There was a young couple tenderly chatting with each other while their bicycles leaned casually on the railing.

But such interventions are not encouraged, because 'orderliness' both spatially and in behavior is the accepted goal of the city's managers and leaders.

In the past, when the washed and steamed rice was brought to the dinner table, the water and the wet stoned pavements symbolized happiness and contentment.⁹ The water system was the focus of the respective neighborhoods, with each individual section of the canal marked out as places for people to gather (Figure 5). People worked with and embraced the natural landscape as a hybrid between culture and geography, with different locations distinctive in their spatial and social character. Eventually, such activities became the idiographic entity of these spaces.

Today, the canal ditches are the reflective objects of people's memories as the spirit of the place and the society behind this. The tangibility of these memories can be found in areas such as the tea corner rather than in the refurbished canals themselves. Perhaps because the canal is no longer really necessary as a functional infrastructure to the economic mechanisms of the city, but Quanzhouers insist on communicating this historical space in their memories through contemporary situations in the today of the city. From the geomantic point of view, despite the loss of its function for the residents, water is still essential for the Carp. Today as part of the urban fabric, canals are more like a decorative water feature; consistent maintenance is part and parcel of the enjoyment of this natural element as an oversized public garden landscape. As Feuchtwang described, *Chinese gardens are designed to relate sentiment inherent in the surrounding*.¹⁰ Quanzhouers can co-create this space by understanding themselves as a feature of the landscape juxtaposed with other objects there. For Quanzhouers this is the meaning of this garden.

Both the historical and contemporary experiences interacted with this element of the nature. Such an interactivity was ingrained in the stable yet changing existential meanings over time. As a mnemonic device, the environment continues to fluctuate. This is then internalized as a palimpsest of personal, social and spatial experience. Within the context of the UNESCO World Heritage application, it is more meaningful for us to reassemble the stories that the location can tell. And if indeed the preservation and celebration of the historic environment are the genuine goal,¹¹ it will be necessary to those changing perspectives back into the everydayness of Quanzhou.

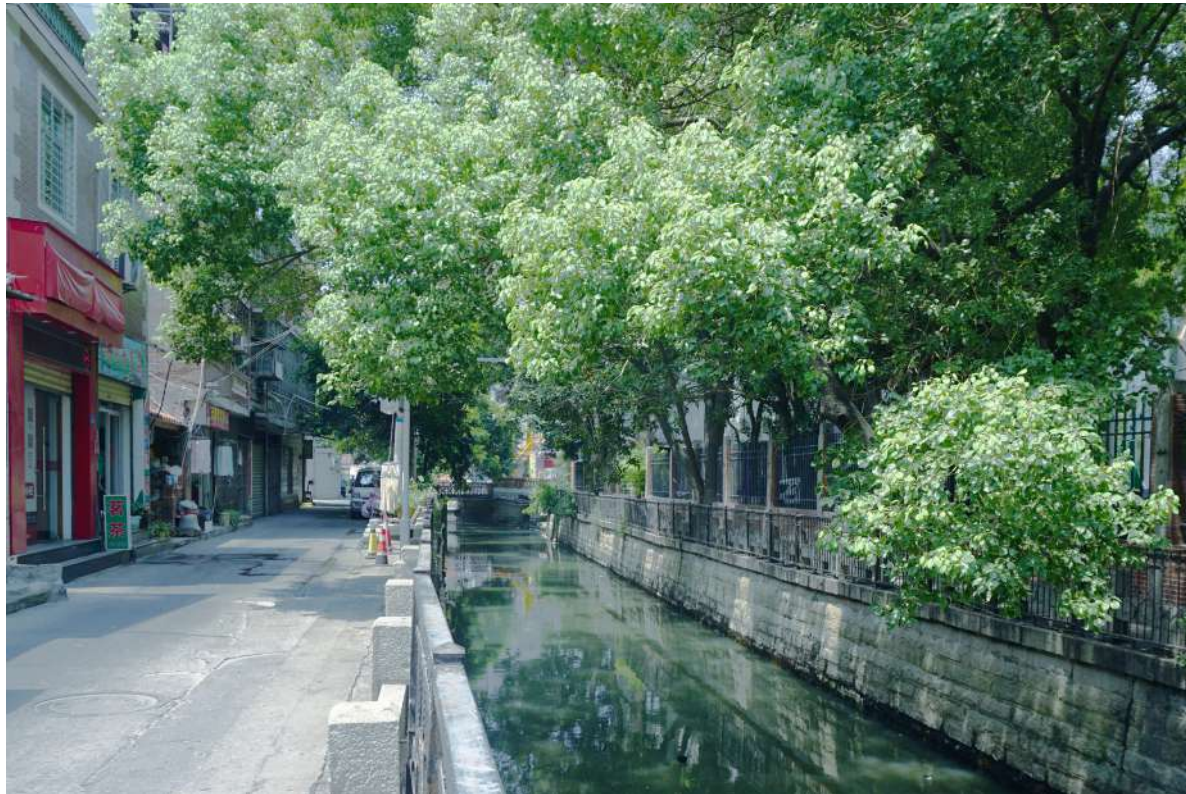
7 Wu, *The memory of river docks in Quanzhou* 泉州内港码头记忆 (2012). It depicts a life scene in the area between 1960s to 1980s

8 Bagua, or Pa kua, are eight symbols used in Taoist cosmology to represent the fundamental principles of reality, seen as a range of eight interrelated concepts.

9 In that era, people get the groceries based on the received tokens from the commune. The society operated as the form of People's commune which was known as collective activity, such as labor and meal preparation. Food and other groceries were much more precious compared with the ones today.

10 Feuchtwang, *Three gestures in a poetics of place-Chinese settlement and disruption* (2005)

11 The author concerns about the genuine goal of the historical preservation actions, as very often, decision makers show the great interest in developing heritage into a commercialism-driven tourism and a potential cultural Chauvinism.



Top Figure 2: Image of canal taken at the Wuan Tou near Deji Gate
Bottom Figure 3: Image of narrow canal taken at Mipu Alley near the embankment

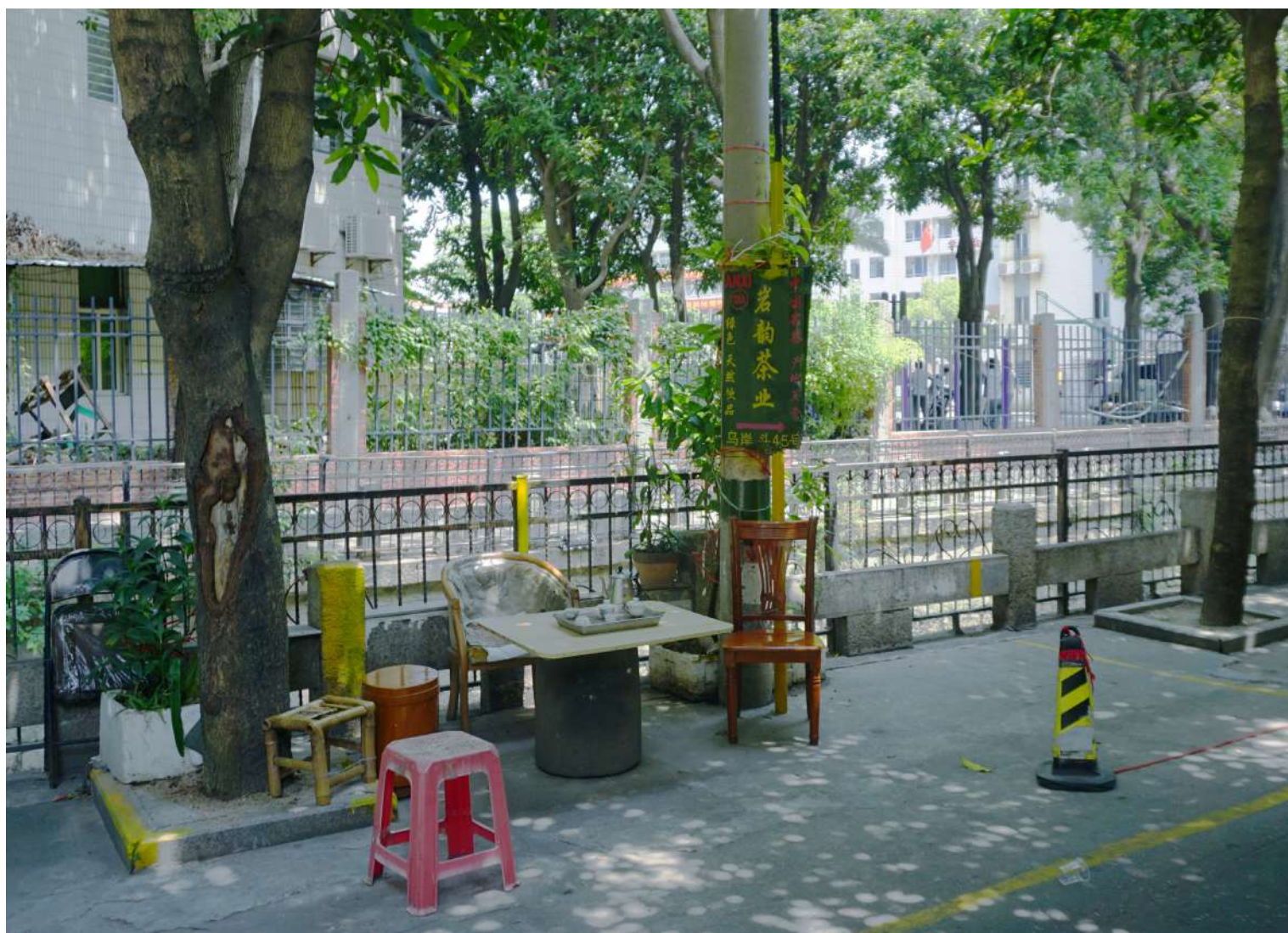


Figure 4: Tea corner next to the canal at Wu'an Tou



Figure 5: Historical photo shows the canal at Che qiao tou in 1958 (the central area of Jubao). Source from <http://www.qztqz.com/p/5168.html>



Figure 6: View of the front court of Fumei Gong towards the edge of Jubao. The temple is at the right hand side of the image. The foyer is composed by multiple elements in different forms and entities. It appears transitory for a long-stay social organization.

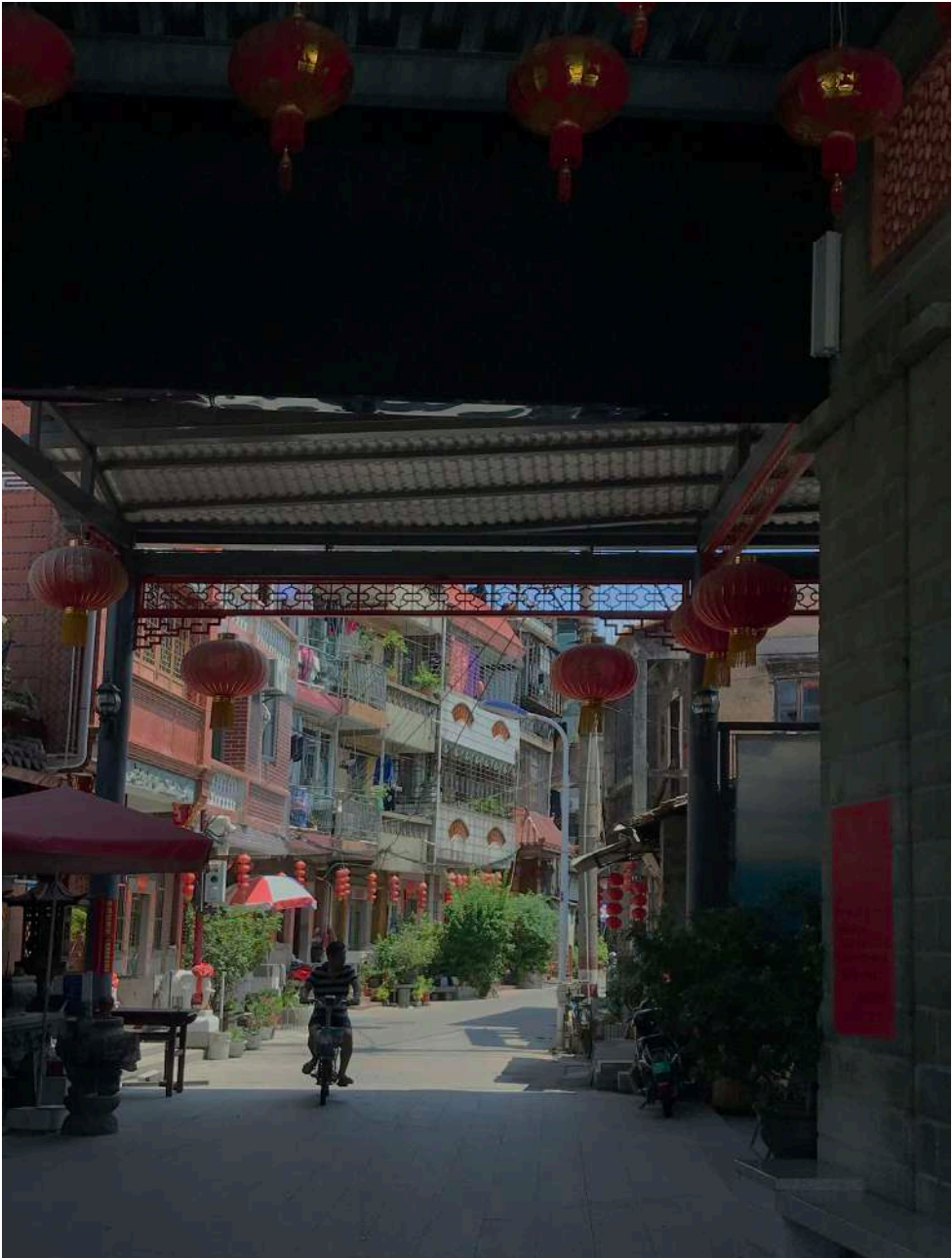


Figure 7: View of the front court of Fumei Gong towards the Jubao town. The aligned houses at the background of the image suggest a spatial indication; Yet the indicator itself: the structure of a portal is invisible.

Note: Out of respect for the temple spirit, author did not take any images of the actual temple.

2.2 Temple-dock order

The people's changed interaction with the canals happened when the river ceased to function as transportation infrastructure. Up to the 1990s, river logistics was still the most effective way to bring the fruitful offerings of the sea and the exotic goods of yonder into the city and its daily life.¹² A glimpse into this past is possible by reading on the concrete forms of their organization bodies remaining today.

Before leaving the central area (che qiao tou)¹³ and reaching the river side, I passed through the neighborhood of a quiet temple: Fumei Gong, a religious community, worships the local god Xiao Taifu (Figure 6&7). This site was also used to protect the fishing and trading activities at the dock, which bore the same name as the temple: Fumei dock. There are some other similar temple organizations along this bank dating back to the Song dynasty (date) and the Houshan Gong temple is only 0.1-kilometer away. The location of these temples suggests not only the boundaries of neighborhoods and different beliefs but also the territory of the old docks and the ethos within them.

When translated into Western languages, Fumei Gong was interpreted as 'church,' 'city hall,' 'chamber of commerce' and 'culture.' It probably was not a coincidence that Fumei was established in the era when the emperors of Ming (1368-1644 AD)¹⁴ were practicing the law of Sea Ban in China¹⁵. When this law threatened the lifeblood of Quanzhouers, these temples stepped in informally and subversively replacing bureaus, excising the duty of managing maritime trade, organizing labor and even helping out financially if necessary. Today, this piece of history is expressed in the special rite of the temples and in festive water ceremony. One such practice is 'borrowing money' from the god in Fumei, where the pilgrims take some coins back with them and place them in front of their home shrines – that is if the oracle of the turtle shell pyromancy agrees. The following year the money needs to be returned to the temple as part of his ritual.

Fumei and the other temples fully reflected the traits of a port city. The temple as the communal 'urbs' denoted the emotions and values of the city. Yet I found very little traces of how Fumei might have operated as part of the daily workings of the quay and the docks. We have to ask ourselves such questions if indeed we want to more closely evaluate the lineage of Quanzhou as a maritime trade center. Besides the temple, what architectural structures existed? Custom houses and warehouses (Figure 8&9) still exist as evidence. But where are they located

now? The official custom house which according to the lore was not allowed to function during the Sea Ban. In fact, it must have still operated in some way or another, and what was its relationship to the temple? What was the nature of the interactions? What was the currency of exchange for continued trade activities? Was this by means of bribery? A beautiful meal or even opium? What spaces sheltered these clandestine meetings? Where was the meal hosted and the opium inhaled? Where did the financial facilitation take place, the lending and borrowing, the exchange of currencies? What kind of building was in service? There was adequately a long line of people outside waiting for their turn.

There are more questions: Concerning commerce, for instance, what was the whole procedure of loading and unloading the goods from the massive trade ships at the jetty? What happened when the wares were transferred to the city from the river bank through the canals? Maybe these boats were made of camphorwood and rattan as Marco Polo described. Yet where were these junks and sampans¹⁶ made and stored?

As already suggested, the trade port identity was closely linked to the social interaction between the temples. According to Huang who was one of Fumei's committee members¹⁷, the temples were highly segregated from one another. The ceremonies of each temple were socially separate. This was in parallel to the goods unloaded at each dock, that were not to be mixed up either. The people who worshipped at Fumei were not friendly with those at the Houshan temple. Historically, they belonged to two opposed gangs. Any mis-arrangements would potentially be the cause of a fight.

The territorial fights among organizations were not started at the jetty. But it was clear that the existential meaning of the dock, the temples, the boundaries between water and land symbolized something competitive and life-related for the people. Besides their usual trade and daily work, they had to be fully involved with and on guard never to transgress this intricate practice of almost tribal rules. Any mistakes on the berth locations or the routes bringing the commodities inland would affect the whole system, thus endanger their livelihoods. The inner land (trade market in the town), the transition land (temple area), the outer land (dock and the bank), even the infinity land (river) were all dotted with remembrancers of positive and negative encounters that were solely based on the identity and lineage of these people.

12 Wu, *The memory of river docks in Quanzhou* 泉州内港码头记忆 (2012)
13 Central area in historical context
14 Fumei Gong committee, *Quanjun Fumei Gong Gazette* 泉郡富美宫志 (1997)
15 Sea Ban, Haijin, was a series of related isolationist Chinese policies restricting private maritime trading and coastal settlement during most of the Ming (1368-1644 AD) and early Qing (1644-1912 AD)
16 Sampan is a relatively flat-bottomed wooden boat. It has been widely used in the region and in South East Asia. It literally means three planks both in Minnanese and Cantonese.
17 As stated in Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the 'Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology'* (2016)

While the system of labor and logistics for trade operated in a line from the temples at the shore towards the docks and water, it was the negotiation and interaction points with others that determined the Genius Loci of this place. The density of trade along the bank was overlaid with the system of markers was like a heterotopic realm: trees and stones would be such meeting points, while people working flowed around these and space was shared among all. The courts in front of the Temples were stages for open disagreements, while the back alleys served the secret agreements. The enclave of the bank was where sport battles took place. Hence, these points of reference for human activity were dispersed in a non-hierarchical way at this entrance point of the Carp City.

The bund was not only a place of work but also an unspoken space to accommodate negotiations and conflicts. As a hybrid space between the city and harbor, it negotiated through these tacit routines and practices the uninterrupted flow of commerce and distribution on which Quanzhou depended. And it was at the intersection where the unity and messiness happened, and from which eventually, the diversity of Quanzhou emerged.

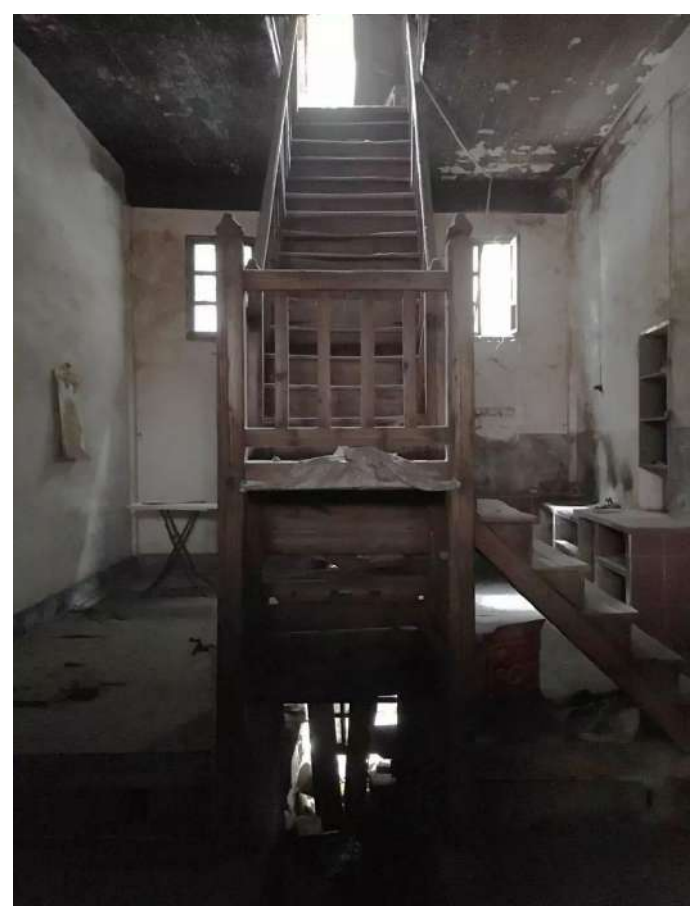


Figure 8: The interior of a historical warehouse in NO.9 Mipu Alley.
Source from Anonymous, Mipu alley, zhushu dock: discover the ancient port warehouse, (2019) retrieved on 30 August 2020, from http://www.qzwb.com/spec/content/2019-03/28/content_5967348.htm



Figure 9: Exterior of the historical warehouse

I continue walking past the temple at the edge of Jubao. The river is still out of sight. In front of me is a horizontal scene of fast-moving traffic and the multiple layers of safety barriers, which make pedestrians walking here vulnerable (Figure 10). Here I tolerated the over-exposure to the sun, and had no real desire to seek the scene of mother river just beyond this urban boundary. Still, I was waiting for the vehicles to slow down. A mini sightseeing bus motored by the electricity¹⁸ ignored the horns of the car behind and stopped. The driver told me to hop on the golf-cart like bus for free. It was on its way to the “old town”. The driver’s friendly yet persistent eyes implied that nobody was to have to walk here. I refused him politely, the bus moved on, and eventually I managed to reach to the other side of the road.

There I find some fishing boats, poorly maintained shelters, and the skeletons of fish and fowl scattered at certain spots along the embankment (Figure 11&12). They are like the detached parasites relying on the structure of a concreted motorway, which is at a perfect eye-level to block the view. It is sad that once the city’s pride, the embankment has now become completely derelict and that the livelihood it provides is shameful and poor. Apparently, the fishermen are legal according to the online document published by the city construction and planning bureau. Mr. Chen who casually runs an antique shop on a street in nearby Jubao, explains to me that river fishing is still operating, the people from those boats below the highway come to the township and to sell their seafood there. I imagine how they climb up the levee and cross the road. Where are the legitimate infrastructures for them? The fishing is not extinct, but the urbs for it has gone.

The actual impact of the water on our spatial imagination has been modified today by the infrastructures of modernity made of the concrete, asphalt and steel. The most noticeable intervention is the insertion of an ‘edge’ between the river and the settlement: a high wall, two motorways, and place-less streetscapes. This concept¹⁹ of urban planning has separated the original hybrid space of ‘river-land’ into two constituencies. The linear gesture is so defined that it slices through the radiant pattern of the temple-dock order. Jubao Chengnan, historically outside of the administration system of the walled city has now been fenced in and fenced off. It is no longer the heterotopic intersection of City and Harbor.

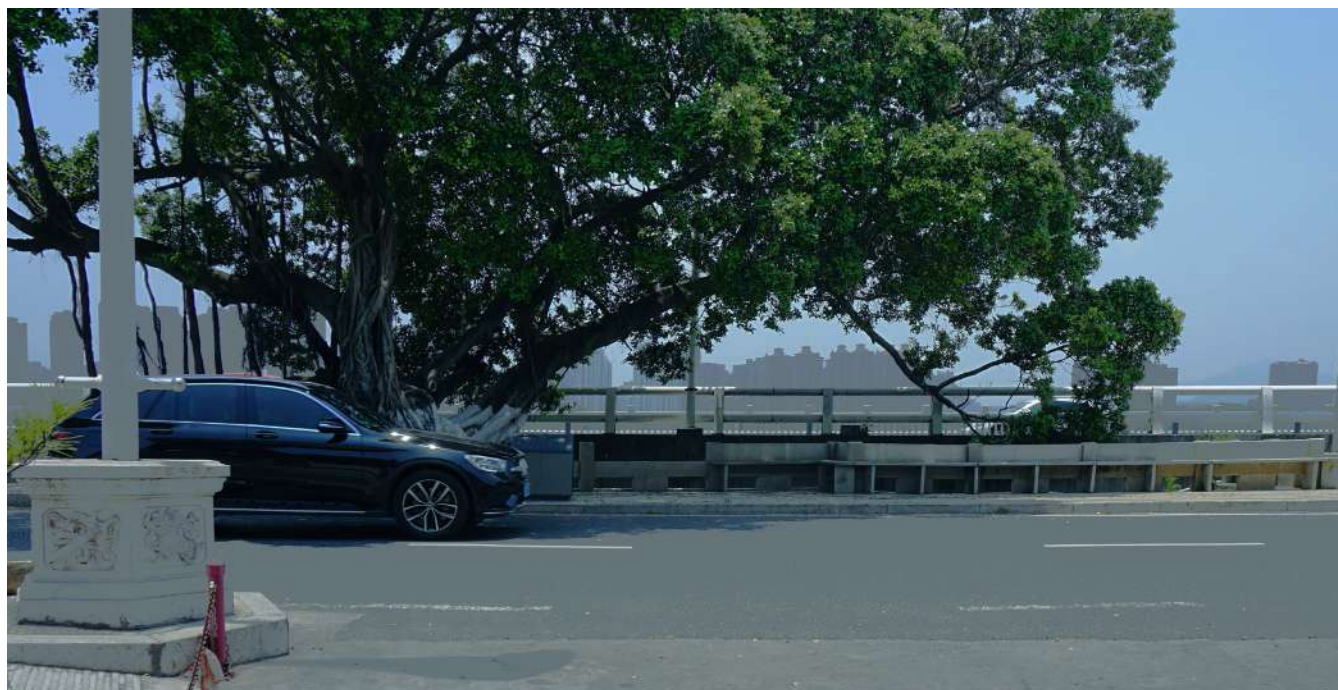


Figure 10: The view outside the Fumei “gate”, showing the layered structures towards river Jin.

18 The electrical sightseeing bus started operating since September of 2019, the ticket price is fixed at 2 yuan
 19 Node, Edge, Landmark, Path, District, see Lynch, *The image of the city* (1960)



Top Figure 11: The motorway and the Quanzhou Bridge across the river Jin have been the best shelter for the sporadic fishing boats.
 Bottom Figure 12: The major spot along the bank for the fishing boats to park

2.3 Assembly Line

The high floodwall was built in December 1959, encompassing the whole southern periphery of Jubao Chengnan (Figure 13&14). It was part of the project initiated in 1955 that included the construction of culverts, floodgates and involved the relocation of 250,000 residents. It was all about preventing the severe flood damage to the lower bank of river Jin caused by the typhoons.²⁰ While the project was successful in mitigating natural disasters, it destroyed the porous and messy attributes of the cultural landscape of the old dock. In spite of this, people started a new spatial language in this area was still possible as long as the river remained the most important source of the everydayness of the city.

20 Luo, *The history of flood-control bank, Fanghongdi shihuai* 防洪堤史话, from *Quanzhou City Cultural and Historical Archive, 4th column* 泉州鲤城文史资料 第四辑 (1989)



Top Figure 13: The high wall and the cement facade viewed from the river bank.
 Bottom Figure 14: The interior parapet wall with the significant granite block

The description of the docks by Wu²¹ from the 1960s to the 1980s depicted a vivid collective impression of how the quay of Jubao operated. After many years of uncertainty²², the embankment was reactivated, but differently compared with that of the temple-dock. Having refurbished, reorganized and renamed the riverside, nine docks in total laid on the newly-furnished 870-meter long river bank. There were new jetties in each of the docks. The former orders, including the mysterious Song-Yuan system, were rewritten with a modern and communal stroke. In the government's macro maneuver, the bund became the pioneer of the industrial modernization even before the city itself.

Unlike the temple-dock culture, the material environment of the quay in Wu's description was filled with the categorization of commodities. Based on their nature and surrounding conditions and the existing urban roles of the projecting streets and intersections, the docks were allocated to serve cargos of specific goods. For instance, the seafood and the salty water that came from the seaside villages were unloaded from the boats at the Second Dock for its direct transfer to the canal that led to the streets of Jubao, and the market within the interior of the walled city so that the fresh goods could be sold as quickly as possible.

The Third Dock and its loading and unloading jetties received timbers, cement, fresh fruits, dried fruits and exported chinaware as well as red woods and the root of dyeing yam, that would be boiled and was then used to color the fishing nets and the sails of the boats. The Ninth Pier²³ had an excellent loading capacity, receiving large goods, including the bulk of coal from the north of the country. The existence of the auxiliary hub for the female porters to rest, chat and gather at the Third Dock and the male shower facility in the dark-colored Ninth Dock made a different spatial meaning to both the occupiers and observers like Wu.

The spatially abstracted line of labor that inscribed itself from the shore towards the river still existed but in the form of the assembly lines in modern factories. The archetype of a modern port emerged in a decisive communal manner. We can try to imagine the textures and colors of the still 'primitive' port environment through Wu's memories: Would the dried fruits that dropped on the timber jetties follow the rubber shoe soles of the female porters and leave blotches of color and fragrance on the Third Dock? Was the young Wu amazed by the display of ceramic wares packed in the glass vitrines in that exchange station for imported and exported products nearby that he

mentioned? On the other hand, according to the description, nobody would miss the white-tiled inspection station in the middle of the black dust of the coal yard of the Ninth Pier. The mysterious texture of the coal extracted from the earth from a strange part of the country rendered landing dock a forbidden compound, which Quanzhouers avoided. Thus, the meaning of the quay was strongly associated with the new functional divisions and the "performances" they required. People were aware of which space to go to and not to go to depending on written or spoken rules. These were explicit and understood during this period, compared to the messy and unknow rituals of the temple-dock era, in which the anarchic meeting places of exchange within the older cultural landscape were substituted by formal regulation.

Jubao was transformed and designed based on the needs of the community and work on the port. Examples are the apartment blocks that had been built for the porters and their families that were now juxtaposed to the temples and churches of the ancient orders. However, what remained untold in Wu's story dating from the 1960s to the 1980s is that the port as the forefront of the city was also experiencing turbulence both from the ongoing changing political landscape as well as through modernization. The Civil War (1927-1949), the Cultural Revolution (1966-1976), the Great Leap Forward (1958-1962) and the Economic Stagnation (1970) finally made way for the opening of the economy (1970-1980), but also caused poverty and anxiety. Might the unspoken space for conflict and negotiation still be present somewhere under the surfaces of the nine docks? Where were the spiritual spaces to safeguard the fishing still possible under the control of the atheist Communist Party, and if yes, in what form and ritual? How did the transfer of warehouse ownership happen and how did this affect the spirit of surrounding streets and neighborhood? A woman who might have once been the housewife of a well-to-do merchant²⁴, perhaps, now was forced to be a "modern blue-collar woman" during the Cultural Revolution. Yet how did she cope with this, and how was her living space transformed into a station for the army?²⁵ Below the layers of new rules and behaviors, what shape was taken up by the unspoken area? An important reminder is roused here to recognize the fact of the changing history. However, what is more critical in capturing the city's essence is how this changed the urban spaces and how people made sense of their new environment.

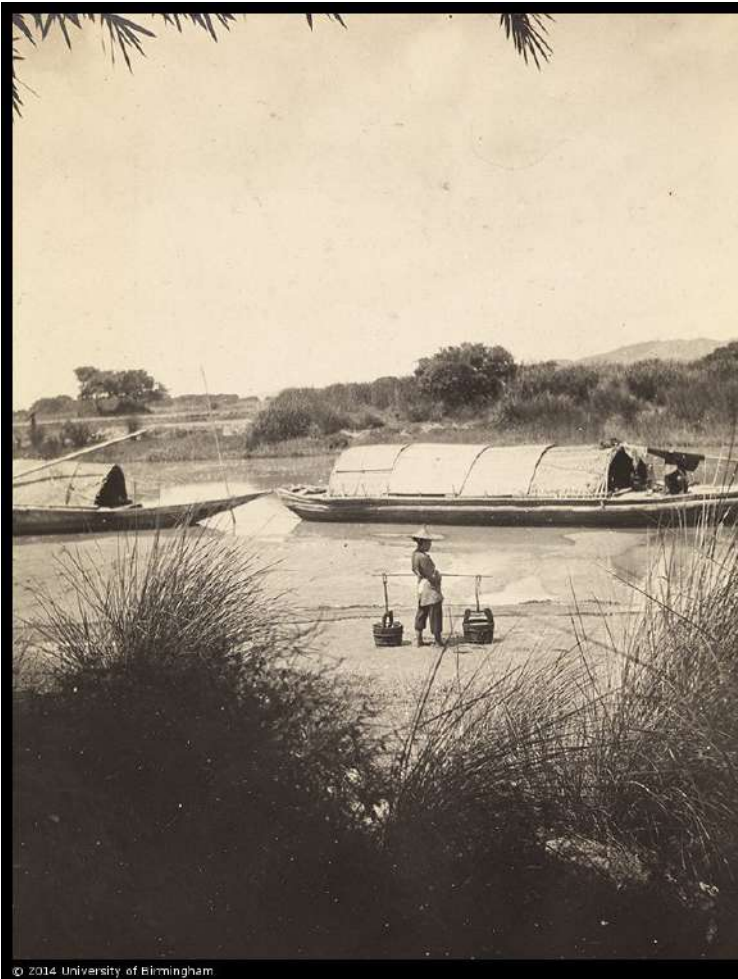
21 Wu, *The memory of estuary docks in Quanzhou* 泉州内港码头记忆 (2012)

22 China was in the huge turbulence since the beginning of 19th century until 1940s (wars with Western colonist, civic wars, etc.)

23 Ninth Pier was not at the Jubao bund, but in a close distance to the south.

24 The story of aunt Li, refer to Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the 'Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology'* (2016)

25 The house of Chen qiaomu 陈乔木故居, refer to Anonymous, *Mipu alley, zhushu dock: discover the ancient port warehouse*, (2019) retrieved on 30 August 2020, from http://www.qzwb.com/spec/content/2019-03/28/content_5967348.htm



Left Figure 15: Boat landing at Chinchew. 'Among the baskets and luggage is what looks like a tripod case with Maxwell's name on it; Two hurricane lamps; and a trunk with a name on it. Mostly obscured, but ending'.

Right Figure 16: The creek of Chinchew. The photo shows the Dutou of Quanzhou and the sampans with rattan covers.

Both photos taken around 1900-1910, from the collection of Maxwell Family. Copyright owned by University of Birmingham, source retrieved 10th June from <https://www.hpcbristol.net/tag/chinchew>

2.4 Matou and Dutou

I was struggling to find an English word to describe the infrastructures of the river-bank that conveyed men and goods. It turns out that there are many variations of the names in different countries, even in the English-speaking world. For the purpose of understanding, I have referred the whole Jubao facility with its granite and concrete embankment construction alongside the river as a quay. Each of the nine boat-mooring areas is described as a dock following the nomination dossier of other estuary docks. The word pier refers to the elevated platform extended from the land into the water and a jetty is a small-scaled stone or wooden protrusion. With the specifically Chinese context, there is the word Matou often used today generally to include all the ports, quays, docks, jetties, etc. and their auxiliary facilities. There is another much older word Dutou²⁶ (Figure 15&16) which in Chinese culture refers to the place to cross the river. While the definition is simple and abstract, just like many other art forms in China, there is an unspoken indication concealed within it. Composed by the words Du – a water-related process from here to there – and Tou – literally meaning head, and implies the point to set off from – the name Dutou often implicates the notions of the wistfulness of farewell, the helplessness towards danger and the unknown of what lies in the future. For instance, there is a Minnaness ceremony called Pu Du (the same Du), which is a rite to lead a life of suffering to attain a better life in the hereafter.²⁷

²⁶ Dutou 渡头, refer to the poem in Nan Dynasty (420-589), retrieved on 30 August 2020, from <https://www.zdic.net/>. The map in late Qing dynasty still showed the name of Dutou

²⁷ Pudu 普度, relates to Buddhist festival, refer to Tan, *Chinese religion in Malaysia* (2018), Chapter 6, p.84

Today the word Matou has mostly replaced Dutou. The older temples at the bund were dedicated to a Dutou order while the one dating from the 1960s was served the Matou according to Wu. The Matou urbs of Wu's was simple and referred to the reinforced walls, parapets and the platforms (Figure 17). Yet because of the underlying spatial structure, I argue that it still bore a richness in the material environment implicit of mystery, just like the word Dutou.

Unlike today's Matou, which either functions as a pure industrial workspace or as a passenger terminal aims to be an urban landmark, Jubao docks (or the Dutou, including the estuary docks in the UNSECO nomination (Figure 17) are hard to describe using contemporary language. The no longer existing structures were highly hybrid in their history and influenced by different social groups. Furthermore, without the corresponding narration of the surrounding urban components, it is even more challenging for the historical and cultural identification to resonate on its own. In the past, the stories of the canals, the temple-dock and the modern Dutou elaborated the profound interrelationship between the humans who inhabited these spaces through their work routines and everyday life and the changing Genius Loci of their relationship to the water. All of these spaces, as reciprocal political and social environments, had also accommodated different unseen or untold spaces to help facilitate changes. In the accumulation of social and political forces throughout their history, the symbols and metaphors between the city and the quay both changed over time yet simultaneously becoming intertwined with each other. The request for 'authenticity' by UNESCO seems inadequate to embrace this complicated palimpsest. The moments in which humans scrape and wash off the previous historic layers need more attention in the study of heritage, so too does the question of where we choose to rewrite and overlay.

Within the specifically Chinese context needs to be also considered that all these processes do not necessarily happen openly or explicitly. Just as the Chinese do not like to explain the precise sentiments implicit in the word of Dutou, I agree with the interpretation by Feuchwang '*leaving room for mutual and implicit understanding*'.²⁸ Such an essential characteristic at the cultural core of Quanzhou's civitas is not really represented in the contemporary urbs.

For the majority of Quanzhouers, the current meaning of the Jubao bund is not even a port; it is a passing view from the speeding car on the motorway. Yet the elevated road blocks

out the full picture of the area's inhabitation. The discrepancy between the rich heritage of the area and the poorly-maintained physical shreds of evidence is noteworthy and shocking. The interconnections are present but loose and also challenging for the public to read. Surprisingly, even the memory of the near history, the collective of the nine docks, are not well defined within Jubao's current street landscape. Perhaps only history enthusiasts able to read the past of the long granite blocks and their black grouting, which were typical of buildings of that era in the late 20th century and used both for the construction of the high sea wall as well as the residential houses. The temples with their gods, however, still safeguard the place and welcome everyone as they always have, but having been ignored and overlooked by the people in charge of urban planning.

The State Party nominated none of the objects or sites in this area in the 2018 UNESCO submission. Because the docks had disappeared and the meanings they carried in their fabric had evaporated with them, it was probably thought that Jubao Chengnan did not deserve special commemoration. Modernization projects such as the beltway, the bridges connecting adjacent lands above the river took over the role of the quay as urban infrastructure. Society's desire for speed had assertively excluded that 'outdated' river system as part of the city's everydayness. In the fervor to make China modern, the bridge was a symbol of progress²⁹, signifying a progressive society. The highways and train systems wound themselves like snakes around Quanzhou's mountains and crossing the rivers over the new bridges. The singular aim was to shorten the distance between the surrounding towns and countryside and provide the foundation for the ultimate goal: an integrated bay area³⁰.

28 Feuchwang, *Three gestures in a poetics of place-Chinese settlement and disruption* (2005)

29 Holmes, *Building Bridges and Breaking Boundaries: Modernity and Agoraphobia* (2006)

30 Hong, *Regional integration, establish a central marina city- The thinking of the urban strategy of macro- Quanzhou bay area* (2007)



Figure 17: Historical photo of Ninth dock in 1980s, copyright owned by Chen Shizhe, source from <https://new.qq.com/omn/20181218/20181218A0LRRF.html>



Figure 18: The photo of meishan estuary dock, copyright owned by Quanzhou Submission body of 2018 UNESCO World Heritage Site bid, source from <http://www.zaytun.org/>

CHAPTER 3

THE MODERN VISUALITY IN THE EAST

Returning to the here and now it will be essential to assess the relationship of the water body and its engagement to the public. Browsing social media, the popular noticeable locations are the historical fabric of Carp on the inland, what was formerly the old walled town city, but also the new high-rises and the shopping complex situated at the “new” Quanzhou harbor front. 6-kilometer downstream from the Jubao quay and juxtaposed to the remaining estuary docks and Zhenwu temple which were included in the UNESCO nomination, facing the river is located a ‘sky wheel’ as part of new mixed-use development. The project¹ is one of the Quanzhou-great-bay urban planning projects that are erecting in Donghai.

The first large-scale iron and steel Ferris wheel was created for the 1893 Chicago World’ Fair by a company that tested these structural materials for the bridges and railways then under construction. This gigantic wheel was to amaze the visitors, intended to surpass the wonder of the Eiffel Tower in the earlier World’s Fair in Paris (1889). Ever Since then, Ferris wheels have been a celebrated architectural approach to establish an image of urban modernity, both as a device for viewing the city from above and being viewed from afar as an iconic object in the urban landscape.

Simmel has pointed out that in modernity, the visual has become the predominant sensory mode.² The Ferris wheel in Donghai allowed the new metropolitan city to unfold while being the passengers inside the wheel cabins were up in the air with the skyscrapers while taking in the river Jin as a part of the scene beyond. The water and its bund are no longer the source of everyday life as it had been with the old orders, but have become an object on display for visual consumption. The photos of and from the sky wheel and the glaring glass facades of office towers as the backdrop represent progress, refinement, and the new. The river in this setting is a feature of a generic globalized urban image and no longer speaks of a complex and diverse Quanzhou identity.

1 The development is called Donghai Taihe Plaza 东海泰禾广场

2 Georg Simmel, German sociologist, philosopher and critic, quoted from Holmes, *Building Bridges and Breaking Boundaries: Modernity and Agoraphobia* (2006)

For most of its history, Donghai was a remote location, removed from Quanzhou's urban culture and heritage. The real foothold of maritime culture and trade routes that had witnessed the voyages of junks with their loads of treasures is denoted by the word Donghai which literally means East Sea. The bright-open shores, the houses made of oyster-shell, and the greenery of this unique place could not possibly be ignored by the easygoing Quanzhouers. Even so, compared with the peaceful scenery of the 1980s (Figure 1), this area in the east has always marked where the river merges with the sea. Approaching from Quanzhou, one has to pass the treacherous hilly terrain using farm roads and passing fishing villages with their respective protective gods before reached to the harbor front. Owing to its proximity to the sea and the hills providing a natural barrier, this land was used during the Ming dynasty (1368-1644 AD) to build a military fortress. All of this marks the place a real harbor, not a city.



Figure 1: The farmland on the foot of Taohua hill in 1980s. Copyright owned by Huang Baining, source from http://qz.fjsen.com/2014-12/24/content_15445505_all.htm



Figure 2: Indication map of the ancient trade routes from Houzhu port to Carp city

Jubao and the bund

Civic center

In this area, two important junk wrecks were found (1974 & 1976)³ Along the country roads (Figure 2), people have discovered the debris of chinaware and stone tablets as well as Arabic Muslim tombs.⁴ The indigenous names of the villages and paths hint at the meaning of the place which originally bore its natural elements and cultural forces: names such as Plum-Bloom Hill Fortress or Lvtuo mews⁵ means 'the donkey that carries loads'. Today these places have been renamed Waterfront Promenade, Harbor Street, etc. Contrasting the older significance of this outlying land, the features of Donghai's geography are suddenly being appreciated for their potential commodification in terms of a globalized generic urban lifestyle. The top of Taohua hill is such an example and has been marked out as a prime location for a golf resort. The structures built for the purpose of moving goods during the Sea Ban and were camouflaged with the rocks to avoid the inspection officers are now exposed under the sun, becoming part of the green vista admired by golfers and residents alike. The long and sinuous coastlines formerly used by fishermen have become perfect locations for hedonic seaside apartments hermetically sealed to sound, airconditioned with the beautiful view as a denaturalized projection. Yet in comparison, their ancestors might have enjoyed the warmth of the generous sun, sky and air, and sound of the waves beyond.

3 One is at Houzhu port next to the river Luo, the other one is at Fashi, near the remaining estuary docks. More details see Green, *Maritime archaeology in the People's Republic of China*. (1997) Chapter 4

4 Huang and Liu, *The investigation of the ancient paths from Houzhu harbor to Quanzhou*, *Houzhu gang tong wang Quanzhou gudao de diaocha*. 后渚港通往泉州古道的调查 (1978)

5 Plum-bloom hill fortress, Meiling Guan 梅岭关, Lvtuo mews, Lvtuo xiang 驴驮巷, English translation by Author, source from Ibid

The new Donghai development was launched at the beginning of 2007 and still is expanding.⁶ In 2011, Quanzhou's civic bureaus were relocated from the Carp city, shutting down the historic city's administrative role after one thousand and five years. This was followed by new hospitals, large shopping malls, high-rise offices, and residential towers.

Quanzhouers nicknamed the culture center including its opera house, a library, and exhibition halls 'the four golden flowers' because of its plan configuration, form and color (Figure 3). The design intention was to resemble the shape of tung tree flowers⁷ because the word 'ciron' meant this in the local dialect and was echoed in the name of the city as Zayton.⁸ The civic center itself appears to lean against the hill was like a gigantic vessel that is ready to sail⁹, clearly symbolizing the ambition of the new metropolitan Quanzhou. Interestingly, before the relocation was finalized, there had been many doubts. People found it hard to believe that the heart of the city would leave the body of the carp. But already when engineers had conquered the longest distance between the lands across Quanzhou Bay by putting a bridge across it (Figure 4), no one was terrified of the net any longer, nor worried about what might happen to the fish.

However, the symbolism of the golden flower or the large vessel is very different from that of the carp and those in Jubao. The modern metaphors are primarily based on the ability to visualize from the up in the sky or afar. The encapsulated Golden Flowers (Figure 5) need no natural forces like the sky, earth, light and shadow. Instead, they create an artificial climate inside the blossom containers for those insides (Figure 6). The deliberate display of the cultural center's signage and the overemphasis of the metaphor has somehow sterilized any reciprocity between the urbs and its civis, the exchange that happened naturally through the order of temple-dock or later even when the specialization dock was built. Hence, the synthetic production of meaning is unilateral in the hands of the developers and the architects, having cut off the messiness of a slower and more fluid cultural manifestation.

Yet the Carp citizens have brought their urban habits to the stark, wide boulevards of new Donghai. The electric bikes and scooters unhurriedly weave across both the pedestrian walkway and vehicle roads alike. Together, moving with the ebb and tide of the traffic lights, their rhythm and synchronicity appear like a parade performing next to the Golden Flower Opera House.

6 Anonymous, *The planning of four parcels in Donghai aggregations, Quanzhou Evening Paper* (2007.11), retrieved on August, 25, 2020 from Quanzhou Fengze government website http://www.qzfz.gov.cn/zwgk/xwzx/fzxw/200711/t20071116_1843509.htm

7 Scientific name: *Erythrina variegata*

8 The original local pronunciation of Zayton. The name came from the flourishing tung trees used to grown in the Carp Town.

9 Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the "Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology"* p.34



Top Figure 3: The night view of the Four Golden Flowers. Copyright owned by Zhang, from Weibo account https://weibo.com/u/2598355141?is_hot=1
Bottom Figure 4: The view from Donghai towards Quanzhou Bay bridge. Copyright owned by Zhang Jiuqiang, source from <http://www.qztqz.com/p/39165.html>



Figure 5: The interior of library reading room. The LED “sky” is showing the nature scene of Quanzhou



Figure 6: The entrance of Quanzhou library is marked by the grand staircase and signage on the wall. The skin of the Golden flower encapsulates the reading experience.

CHAPTER 4

CONCLUSION

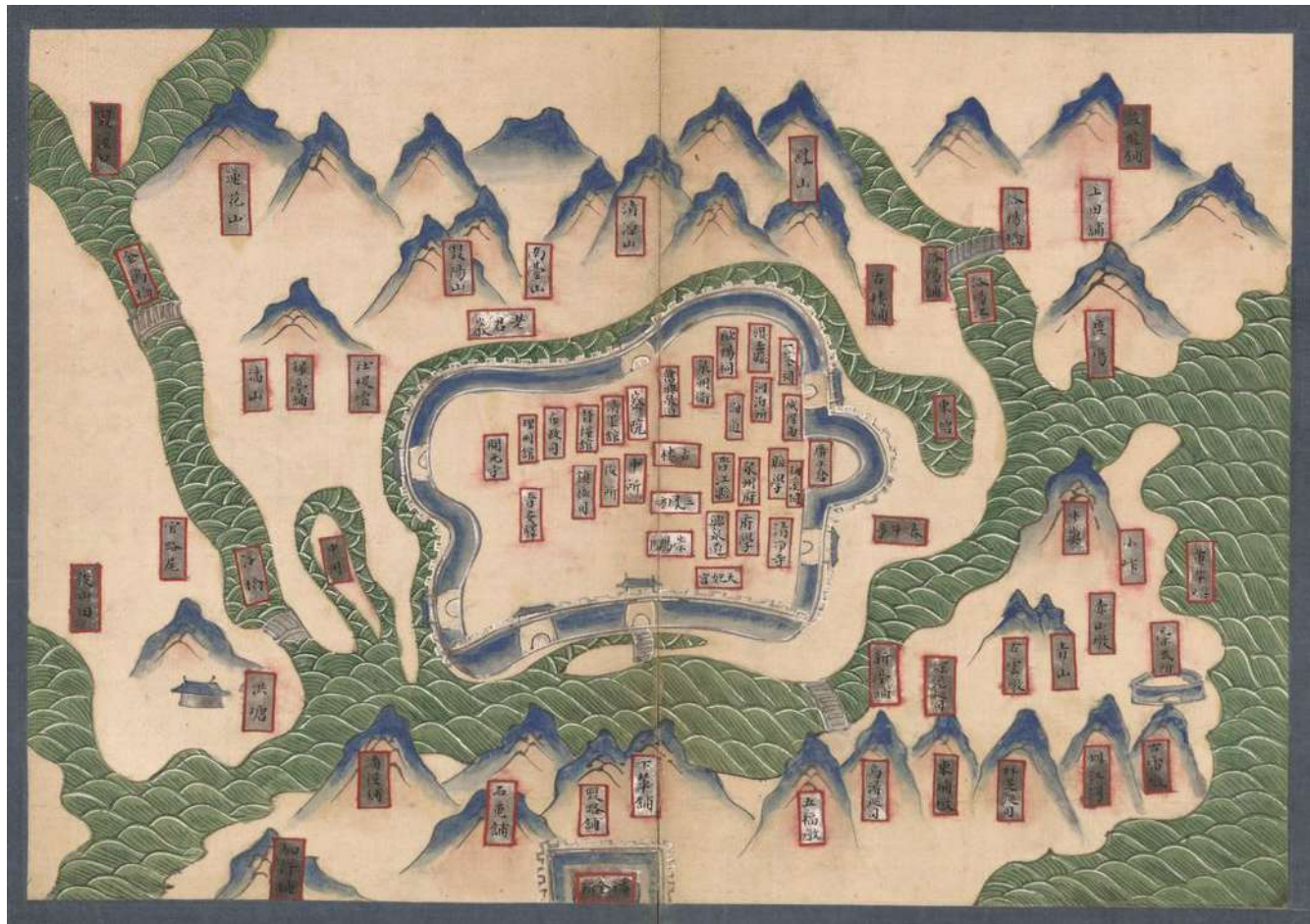


Figure 1: Illustrated atlas by pen-ink and watercolor of Quanzhou Prefecture dated back to 1602. It covers land and territory of Quanzhou, shows cities, towns and military posts in Quanzhou fu.

Original manuscript reposites in Library of Congress Geography and Map Division Washington, D.C. 20540-4650 USA dcu. Image source from Online access of Library of Congress, <https://www.loc.gov/resource/g7824qm.gct00244/?sp=4&r=-0.148,0.204,1.033,0.479,0>

The earliest available map of Quanzhou dates back to 1602 (Figure 1). In it the water of both the ocean and the manmade moats was represented in green with pattern that at first looks like waves, but on closer inspection, at the east of the walled city, the lake – now called East Lake – has been painted to resemble the head of a snake and we suddenly recognize the waves to be scales. This metamorphosis of water and serpent is a common symbol used in this region.

For me the snake denotes both hostile and amicable emotions of Quanzhou's peoples towards the sea. On most early Chinese maps, the ocean was either absent altogether or marginalized¹ because of its remoteness from the central plain. The fear of snakes appears in in the myth of river Luo were snake represented wild and unpredictable danger of nature's wild forces. In this myth a terrible wind storm that had been caused by wicked fairies living up among the hills, to blow the passengers of a boat into mid-stream. The wind then transformed into a river snake who devoured the poor people alive.² The snake of Quanzhou however appears benign and even protective, as it wraps itself around the walled-city like a shield. In legend it is said that people in Fujian, were the offspring of snakes³, and the serpent was the guardian of their homes and livelihoods, they were a sort of genius loci.⁴

1 Liang, *China in the sea map, brief introduction of ancient sea map of China* 海图上的中国：中国古代海洋地图需要. (2018), preface

2 Boxer, *South China in the Sixteen Century (1550-1575)*, Appendix III, The great granite Bridge of Fukien

3 Xu, *Shuowen Jiezi* 说文解字 (discussing writing and explaining characters), (100 CE)

4 The meaning of the snake as a kind of genius loci, refer to Boyce, *Significance of the serpents on Pompeian house shrines*, (1942). P.21

Water in its guise as a protective snake or important in the analogy of the auspicious carp, was sacred for Quanzhou, both regarding the material and intangible environment of the city. The identity of its citizens with its profound cultural and social connotations routed firmly in the nature landscape as an unconscious backdrop to their lives. If not always clearly reflected within the urban grain, it functions nonetheless a palimpsest of these two interconnected forces through time.

In my stories of Quanzhou, I tried to rediscover the existential meaning of the river to the people. But in reverse, I have also explored the human reactions to the water within their urban spaces. The built forms, but also the smell, color and texture have become mnemonic devices. As a Quanzhouer myself, I am a cultural magpie, taking foreign concepts and integrating them within this hybrid analysis of my city. I have particularly enjoyed the idea of 'urbs' and 'civitas' allowing the implicit negotiation of spaces within the town as an arena for debate.⁵ I have also come to understand the water-related settlements outside the city walls as very particular and unique heterotopias that distinguish Quanzhou from other harbor cities. They are heterotopias in the sense that they balance and augment the order of the town through their less controlled activities while the norm of the walled-city order was suspended⁶.

In contrast to the methodology used for the UNESCO nomination, the narrative in this essay started from the site, collected the elements from the location itself and explored their almost disappeared stories. The phenomena of the past and present are like a rolling ball, the narration is the ground that tracks and traces its motion. Each time the surface of the ball hits the ground the marks and lines are different. And that leaves a question to Quanzhouers today: how to we move forward, replace and rewrite our historic trajectory while yet preserving the essence of our past?

As Feuchtwang has pointed out, unlike in the West, Chinese space and narrative usually occurs within an untold world. Hence the modern construction of China consistently struggles between the two. The integrated city⁷ of a Great Quanzhou Bay aims for easier governance and also declares the sovereignty of Quanzhou within its current administrative territory. It is all about improving Quanzhou's standing in comparison with other Chinese cities. While this was also the reason for the UNESCO bid, to allow Quanzhou to stand out as culturally distinct, the approach does not encourage the expression of cultural individuality through hybridity and the creative tension between

harmony and conflict inscribed into the spaces within these 'messier' urban environments.

The development of Donghai has put an end to Quanzhou's traditional transport system of sea-river-land⁸, as well as the tales of carp, snake and other geomantic principles. Being closer to the sea and having activated the harbor "wonderland", Quanzhou tries to link to its glorious maritime past tangibly, producing a new spatial narrative and meaning as an effigy of Marco Polo stands atop a classical column staring out into the waves, the large-scaled building and the wide boulevards of the new city center form the backdrop to this narrative. Such an ardent yield to the sea is a distinct contrast to the more passive attitude of Jubao towards its river bank. The respectful bow to the sacredness of the ocean has been transformed into a conquest.

However, a recent event, the outbreak of the COVID-19 pandemic, allows for glimmers of hope that Jubao has yet to find its way back into the citizens' imagination and cultural recollection. Having stretched the holiday length from Chinese New Year to the early summer of 2020, the retail outlets inside the Donghai shopping malls remained strictly closes due to the city's lockdown, rendering public indoor space off limits. Slowly, by encouraging merchants to put up booths and stalls outside, the government hoped it reinvigorate trade. All of a sudden, the landscaped water pond outside the modern complex was bustling with individual peddlers selling food, toys, books and daily necessities. The lively scenes of the Jubao bund and street scenes of bygone days reappeared within a different material environment together with things that do not change such as the shouting kids, the clamor for bargains, and Quanzhouers' fondness of street life at large.

The complexity of my story of the harbors of Quanzhou shows in the relationship between its land and water, hybrid genius-loci and religious markers as well as a social system that grapples with identities that span between private and state ownership to vernacular cosmology and communal Fordism. Perhaps as such it can serve as an example among China's other modern cities, to allow for a rethinking that allows modern life and urban environments to incorporate the spontaneity of streets, alleys and urban nodes as public gathering spaces, which have embodied the layers of culture and the soul of a historic city, yet without indulging in too much of a nostalgic reenactment.

5 Memorial landscape through the metaphors of 'text', 'arena', and 'performance'. Dwyer & Alderman, *Memorial Landscapes: analytic questions and metaphors* (2008)

6 Foucault, *Of other spaces, Heterotopias*, Translated from Architecture, Mouvement, Continuité no.5 (1984), p.46-49

7 Hong, *Regional integration, establish a central marina city- The thinking of the urban strategy of macro- Quanzhou bay area* (2007)

8 Wang, *Jubao Chengnan: A Human Ecological Investigation of the "Garden of Minnan Cultural Ecology"* p.34

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